

PayFix AI 2.0 Product Backlog, User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

Field	Value
Document	Product Backlog, User Stories and Acceptance Criteria
Project	PayFix AI 2.0
Version	1.0
Status	Backlog Analysis – In Progress
Owner	Roshan Thakur
Requirements Baseline	PayFix AI 2.0 Requirements Baseline v1.0
Requirements Count	228
Delivery Strategy	Agile / Scrum with Kanban-supported analysis
Core Delivery Horizon	H1 – Core Process Foundation
Automation Horizon	H2 – Selective Automation
AI Pilot Horizon	H3 – Controlled AI Evaluation
Conditional AI	H4
Jira Project	PayFix AI 2.0
Scenario	Synthetic Portfolio Project

1. Purpose

This document translates the PayFix AI 2.0 requirements baseline into an Agile product backlog comprising Epics, User Stories, analysis tasks, acceptance criteria and supporting delivery items.

The purpose is not to create one Jira ticket for every formal requirement. Requirements are grouped into coherent user- and outcome-focused backlog items while maintaining traceability

to the underlying Business, User, Functional, Data, UX, Control, Non-Functional and conditional AI requirements.

The H1 process, data, workflow and human-control foundation is prioritised before selective conventional automation and controlled AI pilot work.

1.1 Backlog Objectives

ID	Objective
BLO-01	Preserve traceability to the requirements baseline
BLO-02	Organise delivery around coherent user/business outcomes
BLO-03	Avoid one-ticket-per-requirement decomposition
BLO-04	Keep stories small enough for meaningful delivery/refinement
BLO-05	Keep acceptance criteria testable
BLO-06	Make dependencies visible
BLO-07	Preserve human decision/control boundaries
BLO-08	Include accessibility and assisted-service needs
BLO-09	Distinguish core, automation and AI delivery horizons
BLO-10	Keep AI pilot work separate from core-service dependency
BLO-11	Support future Scrum planning
BLO-12	Support testing and UAT traceability

2. Backlog Hierarchy

Requirements Baseline



Delivery Package



Jira Epic



User Story / Technical or Analysis Task



Acceptance Criteria



Test Case / UAT Scenario



Evidence

Formal requirements remain the analytical source of truth. Jira backlog items represent delivery units derived from those requirements rather than replacing the requirements catalogue.

2.1 Backlog Item Types

Item	Purpose
Epic	Large coherent product/delivery capability
User Story	Deliverable behaviour or outcome from a user perspective
Task	Necessary delivery work that is not naturally expressed as a user story
Spike / Investigation	Time-boxed analysis where information is insufficient
Bug	Defect against expected behaviour
Acceptance Criteria	Conditions demonstrating story satisfaction
Test / UAT Evidence	Evidence that behaviour works as intended

If the Jira configuration does not expose a dedicated Spike issue type, an ordinary Task may be used and labelled as an analysis/investigation item.

3. Product Backlog Epics

Epic Ref	Jira Epic	Horizon
EP-01	Dispute Intake and Case Creation	H1
EP-02	Classification, Routing and Ownership	H1
EP-03	Investigation and Evidence Management	H1
EP-04	Specialist Referral and Review	H1
EP-05	Decisions, Approvals and Closure	H1
EP-06	Customer Status, Communication and Assisted Service	H1
EP-07	Complaints and Escalations	H1
EP-08	Process Data, Audit and Reporting	H1 / Continuous
EP-09	Rules, Automation and Resilience	H1 controls / H2 automation
EP-10	AI Pilot — Evidence Summarisation	H3
EP-11	AI Pilot — Handoff Summarisation	H3

3.1 Epic Content Standard

Every Epic should ultimately show:

- Purpose
- User/business outcome
- Relevant BRs
- Relevant URs
- Main FRs
- Main DRs
- UXR implications
- Control requirements
- NFR implications
- Dependencies
- Delivery horizon
- Important assumptions
- Exclusions
- Related stories

4. User Story Identification

Use portfolio IDs:

US-001

US-002

US-003

and so on.

The Jira issue itself will also receive a Jira-generated key such as:

PFX2-XXX

Portfolio Story ID: US-001

Jira ID: system-generated Jira key

Story IDs should remain stable once assigned. A removed story ID should not later be reused for unrelated functionality.

5. User Story Standard

Use:

As a [user/role], I want [capability], so that [outcome/value].

Example:

As a customer, I want confirmation that my dispute has been received so that I know my dispute journey has started and understand what happens next.

Avoid:

As a database, I want to save records.

5.1 When to Use a Task Instead

Use a Task where the work is primarily:

- technical enablement;
- data configuration;
- monitoring setup;
- infrastructure preparation;
- research/investigation;
- migration;
- control configuration;
- test-data preparation;
- documentation.

Example:

Task — Configure dispute lifecycle reason-code catalogue

rather than forcing:

“As a reason code, I want...”

6. User Story Quality — INVEST

Principle	PayFix Interpretation
-----------	-----------------------

Independent	Avoid unnecessary dependency where practical
Negotiable	Story is not a fixed implementation contract
Valuable	Delivers identifiable user/business value
Estimable	Sufficiently understood before Sprint commitment
Small	Manageable delivery unit
Testable	Acceptance can be demonstrated

Some dependencies are unavoidable in PayFix, particularly where ownership, workflow, evidence, controls or source data must exist before downstream capability can operate.

7. Standard Story Template

Use this template for every substantive story:

Story ID

US-XXX

Title

Short outcome-focused title.

User Story

As a [role], I want [capability], so that [outcome].

Business Context

Why this is required.

Requirements Traceability

- BR:
- UR:

- FR:
- DR:
- UXR:
- CR:
- NFR:
- AIR if applicable:

Process Traceability

- TB stage:
- Gateway:
- Control:

Priority

Must / Should / Could

Delivery Horizon

H1 / H2 / H3 / H4

Dependencies

Relevant stories/capabilities.

Acceptance Criteria

Given / When / Then.

Out of Scope

Where needed.

Assumptions / Questions

Where unresolved.

7.1 Story Naming Rule

Use action/outcome titles such as:

- **Confirm dispute submission**
- **Record customer action required**
- **Assign dispute ownership**
- **Create structured Fraud referral**
- **Record authorised refund approval**

Avoid vague titles:

- Customer feature
- Backend work
- AI improvements
- System update
- Miscellaneous changes

8. Acceptance Criteria Standard

Preferred structure:

Given [starting context]

When [event/action]

Then [observable expected result]

Multiple criteria may be used where a story has several relevant scenarios.

Example:

Given a valid dispute has been submitted,

when the case is successfully created,

then the customer receives confirmation that the dispute has been received.

8.1 Acceptance Criteria Principles

Acceptance Criteria must:

1. describe observable behaviour;
2. be testable;
3. include important alternative paths;
4. include relevant error/exception behaviour;
5. preserve control boundaries;
6. consider accessibility where relevant;
7. avoid implementation detail unless technically necessary;
8. trace to the story;
9. avoid vague words such as “fast”, “easy” or “user-friendly” without defined evidence;
10. avoid inventing production thresholds.

8.2 Scenario Coverage

For important stories consider:

Happy path

Expected successful behaviour.

Alternative path

Valid but different journey.

Exception path

Something requires authorised intervention.

Failure path

Technology/integration fails.

Control path

Approval/human authority required.

Accessibility path

Standard journey is unsuitable.

9. Requirement vs Acceptance Criteria

Requirement

FR-018 — The service shall assign an appropriate queue, role or owner to each active case requiring internal processing.

Story

As a Payment Operations user, I want an active dispute to have identifiable ownership so that responsibility for its progression is clear.

Given a case is ready for Payment Operations processing, when assignment occurs, then its current responsible queue or owner is identifiable.

Requirements describe necessary service capability; User Stories package delivery value; Acceptance Criteria prove that a specific backlog item behaves as intended.

10. Definition of Ready — Story

A story is considered sufficiently ready for Sprint consideration when:

- user or business outcome is understood;
- parent Epic identified;
- relevant requirements linked;
- main process stage identified;
- acceptance criteria are sufficiently clear;
- major dependencies identified;
- important control implications understood;
- important data needs understood;
- accessibility implications considered;
- major unresolved questions identified;
- story is appropriately sized or can be split;
- no unsupported technical assumption is required.

Definition of Ready is used as a practical refinement aid rather than as a bureaucratic gate that prevents useful discovery.

11. Definition of Done — Portfolio Delivery

For a future implemented story, consider Done when:

- acceptance criteria satisfied;
- relevant tests pass;
- important negative/exception paths tested;
- applicable control behaviour verified;
- applicable accessibility checks completed;

- data/event behaviour verified;
- no unresolved critical defect;
- relevant documentation updated;
- traceability updated;
- Product Owner/business acceptance obtained where required in a real delivery context.

A story should not be falsely marked implementation-complete simply because its requirements or acceptance criteria have been written.

11.1 Analysis Completion vs Implementation Completion

During portfolio backlog creation, many stories may be **Ready for Delivery** rather than falsely represented as already implemented.

12. Story Prioritisation

Use MoSCoW but consider:

- parent requirement priority;
- user/business value;
- control criticality;
- dependency;
- H1/H2/H3/H4 horizon;
- risk reduction;
- learning value;
- feasibility;
- accessibility;
- operational need.

A story does not automatically become Must merely because one linked requirement is Must. The story may represent only part of that requirement or may belong to a later delivery horizon.

13. Backlog Sequencing Principles

Sequence 1 — Establish the case

EP-01.

Sequence 2 — Determine where it goes and who owns it

EP-02.

Sequence 3 — Investigate and manage evidence

EP-03.

Sequence 4 — Perform required specialist work

EP-04.

Sequence 5 — Decide, approve and close

EP-05.

Sequence 6 — Keep customer appropriately informed

EP-06.

Sequence 7 — Support complaints

EP-07.

Sequence 8 — Make the service measurable

EP-08.

Sequence 9 — Strengthen rules/automation/resilience

EP-09.

Sequence 10 — Evaluate optional AI

EP-10/11.

This is logical dependency sequencing, not a committed Sprint plan.

13.1 Cross-Cutting Requirements

Some requirements apply across many stories:

- security;
- access;
- auditability;
- accessibility;
- source-of-truth;
- data minimisation;
- recoverability;

- human-control boundaries.

Do **not** duplicate them blindly into dozens of unrelated stories.

Link relevant cross-cutting requirements and include specific acceptance criteria only where the story creates a behaviour requiring that control.

14. Story Splitting Principles

Workflow stage

Example:

submission vs completeness.

User outcome

Example:

view status vs receive notification.

Business rule

Example:

classification vs routing.

Specialist type

Example:

Fraud vs Technical vs Finance.

Happy path vs advanced exception

Only where separately deliverable.

Data capability

Example:

record ownership vs report ownership.

Channel

Only where genuinely distinct.

AI

Always keep AI assistance separable from the non-AI core capability.

14.1 Oversized Story Example

Poor:

As an operations user, I want the entire dispute system to intake, classify, route, investigate, handle Fraud, approve refunds, notify customers and close cases so that disputes are resolved.

Why poor:

- too large;
- multiple actors;
- many business outcomes;
- impossible to estimate meaningfully;
- difficult to test;
- hides dependencies.

Better decomposition:

- Create dispute case
- Assess information completeness
- Classify dispute
- Route dispute
- Assign ownership
- Review evidence
- Refer to specialist
- Record decision
- Communicate outcome
- Validate closure

15. Supporting Delivery Tasks

Some stories may require tasks such as:

- define routing-rule configuration;
- configure lifecycle statuses;
- configure reason-code domain;
- implement event capture;
- prepare test data;

- configure access permissions;
- define notification templates;
- configure monitoring;
- prepare AI evaluation dataset.

16. Analysis / Spike Rules

Use a Spike where a decision genuinely cannot yet be made.

Potential PayFix examples:

- validate real Fraud referral criteria;
- determine real refund authority rules;
- validate availability requirement;
- determine actual performance threshold;
- evaluate integration feasibility;
- evaluate an AI pilot against representative cases.

A Spike should have:

- specific question;
- scope;
- evidence required;
- expected output;
- decision it will support.

17. Story Traceability Model

Discovery / User Need

↓

BR

↓

UR

↓

FR / DR / UXR / CR / NFR / AIR

↓

Epic

↓

User Story / Task

↓

Acceptance Criteria



Test / UAT



Evidence

Traceability should allow a reviewer to answer both:

Why are we delivering this story?

and

Which backlog work addresses this requirement?

18. Story Traceability Register

Stor y ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Req uire men t Link s	Proc ess	Prior ity	Hori zon	Stat us	AC Stat us	Test Link
--------------	------------	------	-------------------	--------------------------------------	-------------	--------------	-------------	------------	------------------	--------------

Stor y ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Req uire men t Link s	Proc ess	Prior ity	Hori zon	Stat us	AC Stat us	Test Link
US-016	PFX-2-32	EP-03	Operational Investigator	FR-020	TB-06	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-017	PFX 2-33	EP-03	Operational Investigator	FR-021	TB-06	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-018	PFX 2-34	EP-03	Operational Investigator	FR-022, DR-011-013	TB-06	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-019	PFX 2-35	EP-03	Operational Investigator	FR-023, UXR - 008/009/012/013/015	TB-06/07	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-020	PFX 2-36	EP-03	Operational Investigator	FR-024, DR-011-013/015-017	TB-07	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-021	PFX 2-37	EP-03	Operational Investigator	FR-025	TB-06/07	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-022	PFX 2-38	EP-03	Operational Investigator	FR-026	TB-06	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
--------	----------	-------	--------------------------	--------	-------	------	----	---------	---------	--------

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
US-023	PFX 2-40	EP-04	Operational Investigator	FR-027, DR-026/027	TB-08	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-024	PFX 2-41	EP-04	Specialist User	FR-028, DR-028/029	TB-08/09	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-025	PFX 2-42	EP-04	Specialist User	FR-029, DR-030/031	TB-09	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-026	PFX 2-43	EP-04	Specialist User	FR-030, DR-030/031	TB-09	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-027	PFX 2-44	EP-04	Specialist User	FR-031, UXR - 008/009/012/013/015/030	TB-09	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-028	PFX 2-45	EP-04	Specialist User	FR-032, UXR - 008/009/012/013/030	TB-09	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-029	PFX 2-46	EP-04	Specialist User	FR-033, DR-030/031	TB-09	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
----------	---------	------	-------------	-------------------	---------	----------	---------	--------	-----------	-----------

US-030	PFX 2-48	EP-05	Decision-Maker	FR-034, CR-001-004	TB-10	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-031	PFX 2-49	EP-05	Decision-Maker	FR-035, DR-032-034, CR-001-004/009	TB-10	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-032	PFX 2-50	EP-05	Approver	FR-036, CR-001-004/009/010	TB-10	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-033	PFX 2-51	EP-05	Authorized Decision User	FR-037, DR-032-034, CR-007/009/010/012	TB-10	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-034	PFX 2-52	EP-05	Operational User	FR-038, DR-032-034/036	TB-10/11	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
--------	----------	-------	------------------	------------------------	----------	------	----	---------	---------	--------

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
US-035	PFX 2-54	EP-06	Customer	FR-039, UR-CUS-003	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-036	PFX 2-55	EP-06	Customer	FR-040, UR-CUS-004/005	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-037	PFX 2-56	EP-06	Customer	FR-041, UR-CUS-003/008	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-038	PFX 2-57	EP-06	Customer	FR-042, UR-CUS - 009, DR-036/037	TB-11	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-039	PFX 2-58	EP-06	Customer	FR-043, UR-CUS - 005/006, CR-016	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
US-040	PFX 2-60	EP-07	Complainants / CS User	FR-044, UR-CO M-001	TB-12	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-041	PFX 2-61	EP-07	Com plain ts User	FR-045, UR-CO M-001	TB-12	Must	H1	Back log	Defi ned	Futur e
US-042	PFX 2-62	EP-07	Ops / Com plain ts User	FR-046, UR-CO M-001, UR-OPS -003	TB-12	Must	H1	Back log	Defi ned	Futur e
US-043	PFX 2-63	EP-07	Oper ation al User	FR-047, DR-038, CR-011/ 012	TB-13/1 4	Must	H1	Back log	Defi ned	Futur e

Stor y ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Req uire men t Link s	Proc ess	Prior ity	Hori zon	Stat us	AC Stat us	Test Link
--------------	------------	------	-------------------	--------------------------------------	-------------	--------------	-------------	------------	------------------	--------------

US-044	PFX 2-65	EP-08	Ops / Assurance / Service	BR-011, BR-017; DR/CR base line allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle / TB-14	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-045	PFX 2-66	EP-08	Ops / Service / Assurance	BR-011, BR-017; DR/CR base line allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-046	PFX 2-67	EP-08	Ops / Service / Assurance	BR-011, BR-017; DR/CR/NFR allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-047	PFX 2-68	EP-08	Ops / Service / Process Mgmt	BR-010, BR-017; DR/ NFR allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle / TB-14	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-048	PFX 2-69	EP-08	Ops / Service / Process Mgmt	BR-010, BR-011, BR-017; DR/ CR/ NFR allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle / TB-14	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-049	PFX 2-70	EP-08	Ops / Service / Assurance	BR-011, BR-017; DR/ CR/ NFR allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle / TB-14	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Requirements Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
US-050	PFX 2-72	EP-09	Ops / Service	BR-003/007/011/012/016; FR/C R/NF R allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-051	PFX 2-71	EP-09	Ops / Control	BR-007/011/012/016; FR/C R/NF R allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-052	PFX 2-72	EP-09	Ops / Control	BR-007/011/012/016; FR/C R/NF R allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-053	PFX 2-73	EP-09	Ops / Service	BR-011/012/016; FR/C R/NF R allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-054	PFX 2-74	EP-09	Ops / Service	BR-011/012/016; FR/C R/NF R allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-055	PFX 2-75	EP-09	Ops / Service	BR-011/012/016; FR/C R/NF R allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
--------	----------	-------	---------------	--	-----------------	------	----	---------	---------	--------

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Links
US-056	PFX2-78	EP-09	BR-003/011/012/015/016; FR/C R/NF R allocation pending	Cross-lifecycle	Should	H2	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-057	PFX2-79	EP-09	BR-003/011/015/016; FR012-019 famil y + DR/C R/NF R pendi ng	TB-04/TB-05	Shoul d	H2	Backl og	Defin ed	Futur e
US-058	PFX2-80	EP-09	BR-002/005/008/011/015/016; appli cable FR/D R/UX R/CR /NFR pendi ng	TB-03/TB-07	Shoul d	H2	Backl og	Defin ed	Futur e

US-059	PFX2-81	EP-09	BR-008/010/011/012/015/016; monitoring/escalation requirements pending	TB-12/TB-14	Should	H2	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-060	PFX2-82	EP-09	BR-008/009/011/015/016; FR039-043 family + DR/UXR/NFR pending	Cross-lifecycle/TB-11	Should	H2	Backlog	Defined	Future

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Links
US-061	PFX2-84	EP-10	BR-011/016; applicable FR/DR/CR/NFR/AIR allocation pending	Investigation / Specialist Review	Should	H3	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-062	PFX2-85	EP-10	BR-011/016; applicable DR/CR/NFR/AIR allocation pending	AI Human Review	Should	H3	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-063	PFX2-86	EP-10	BR-011/016; applicable DR/CR/NFR/AIR allocation pending	AI Pilot Evaluation	Should	H3	Backlog	Defined	Future
--------	---------	-------	---	---------------------	--------	----	---------	---------	--------

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	Requirement Links	Processes	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
US-064	PFX2-88	EP-11	BR-004/010/011/016; applicable FR/DR/CR/NFR/AIR pending	Handoff / Ownership Transfer	Should	H3	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-065	PFX2-89	EP-11	BR-004/010/011/016; applicable DR/CR/NFR/AIR pending	AI Human Review	Should	H3	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-066	PFX2-90	EP-11	BR-004/010/011/016; applicable DR/CR/NFR/AIR pending	AI Pilot Evaluation	Should	H3	Backlog	Defined	Future

18.1 Traceability Cardinality

Requirement-to-story traceability is many-to-many.

One story may satisfy parts of multiple Functional, Data, UX and Control Requirements.

One requirement may also require several stories before it is fully delivered.

Therefore, completeness should be assessed through traceability rather than requiring a one-to-one relationship.

19. Jira Labelling Convention

Use a small controlled set of labels where helpful:

- h1-core

- h2-automation
- h3-ai-pilot
- h4-conditional-ai
- customer
- operations
- fraud
- finance
- technical
- complaints
- data
- accessibility
- control
- ai-assist

19.1 Components — Optional

If the Jira project supports Components, potential logical components are:

- Customer Journey
- Case Management
- Workflow
- Evidence
- Fraud
- Finance
- Technical
- Complaints
- Data & Reporting
- Automation
- AI Assistance

20. Story Workflow

Backlog



Ready



In Progress

↓

Testing

↓

Done

21. AI Backlog Rule

No core H1 User Story should depend on AI for successful completion.

Where AI may assist a core capability, first create and retain the non-AI story.

The AI capability is then represented as a separate H3 or H4 backlog item with its own human-review, fallback and evaluation acceptance criteria.

Example:

Core

Operations user can review evidence.

Separate AI pilot

Operations user can review an AI-generated evidence summary while retaining access to source evidence.

22. Automation Backlog Rule

Similarly:

First define the required business capability.

Then determine whether conventional automation is the appropriate execution mechanism.

Example:

Core requirement:

Customer receives submission confirmation.

Possible H2 implementation:

Automatically send approved confirmation when case creation succeeds.

Do not confuse:

business need

with:

automation mechanism.

23. Non-Functional Requirements in the Backlog

NFRs may be handled through:

1. story-specific acceptance criteria;
2. dedicated enabling stories/tasks;
3. Definition of Done;
4. architectural/testing work;
5. cross-cutting Epic requirements.

Example:

NFR-009 AI independence

should be explicitly tested in relevant AI stories.

But:

NFR-001 security

does not need a separate duplicate story attached to every single backlog item.

24. Control Requirements in User Stories

For control-sensitive stories:

Fraud

Include:

CR-002

Refund approval

Include:

CR-003 / CR-009 / CR-010

Complaint outcome

Include:

CR-004

Overrides

Include:

CR-006 / CR-012

Automation failure

Include:

CR-014

Assisted service

Include:

CR-016

Control requirements should be visible where they materially affect acceptance, rather than remaining hidden in a separate requirements document.

25. Accessibility in the Backlog

Accessibility should not be isolated into one final:

“Make everything accessible”

story.

Instead:

- intake stories include relevant accessibility criteria;
- customer-action stories consider understandable instructions;
- communication stories consider understandable content;
- assisted-service stories explicitly test non-standard pathways;
- final UX validation includes cross-journey accessibility.

26. Acceptance Responsibility

Area	Relevant Acceptance Perspective
Customer journey	Product / Customer Service / UX
Operations	Payment Operations
Fraud	Fraud specialist

Finance	Authorised Finance perspective
Technical	Technical Support
Complaints	Complaints
Data	Data / Process Owner
Control	Relevant control owner
Accessibility	UX / assisted-service perspective
AI	Operational reviewer + Data/AI + controls

27. Story Evidence Status

Status	Meaning
Draft	Story initially written
Analysed	Requirements and scope reviewed
Ready	Meets portfolio Definition of Ready
Implemented	Only when functionality actually exists
Tested	Evidence exists
Accepted	Relevant acceptance evidence exists

28. Jira Story Description Template

For every User Story put:

Portfolio Story ID:

US-XXX

User Story:

As a ... I want ... so that ...

Business Context:

...

Requirements:

BR-...

UR-...

FR-...

DR-...

UXR-...

CR-...

NFR-...

Process:

TB-...

Priority:

Must / Should

Horizon:

H1 / H2 / H3 / H4

Dependencies:

...

Acceptance Criteria:

AC1 — Given / When / Then

AC2 — Given / When / Then

Notes / Assumptions:

...

28.1 Avoid Jira Traceability Overload

Jira should contain enough traceability to explain the story's source and acceptance, but it should not become a duplicate copy of the entire Confluence requirements catalogue.

Detailed requirement definitions remain in Confluence; Jira references the relevant IDs and focuses on delivery.

29. Estimation Position

No story points, developer-day estimates, delivery dates or Sprint commitments are assigned during Step 25A.

Estimation should occur only after stories have been sufficiently refined and the delivery team/context is known.

Inventing velocity or estimates for a synthetic portfolio would not provide meaningful delivery evidence.

30. Sprint Planning Position

Step 25 creates and prioritises the product backlog but does not yet claim that the backlog has been committed to specific Sprints.

Sprint planning should consider story readiness, dependency, capacity, risk and team input.

The portfolio may later demonstrate a sample Sprint plan, but it will be labelled as a proposed delivery simulation rather than a real team commitment.

31. Backlog Quality Checklist

- user/business outcome clear;
- parent Epic identified;
- requirement IDs linked;
- process stage linked;
- story is appropriately sized;
- priority recorded;
- horizon recorded;
- dependencies visible;
- acceptance criteria present;
- control implications included;
- accessibility considered;
- data needs covered;
- AI dependency absent unless explicitly an AI story;
- no vendor unnecessarily prescribed;
- no fake estimate;

- no fake implementation status.

32. BA Interpretation

The PayFix AI 2.0 backlog strategy separates requirements analysis from delivery decomposition while maintaining traceability between the two.

The 228 formal requirements are not treated as 228 independent Jira issues. Instead, the requirements are grouped into eleven coherent Epics and will be decomposed into User Stories and enabling Tasks around user and business outcomes.

The strategy uses a consistent story structure, Given/When/Then acceptance criteria, Definition of Ready, dependency analysis and traceability to support future Scrum refinement.

Core process stories remain independent of AI, while automation and AI capabilities are represented separately so that their incremental value can be evaluated without weakening the non-AI service foundation.

33. Step 25A Conclusion

The PayFix AI 2.0 product-backlog architecture and User Story management approach have been established.

Eleven Epics provide the top-level delivery structure, aligned to the requirement delivery packages and H1–H4 implementation horizons.

User Stories will use stable portfolio IDs, user/outcome-oriented statements, requirements and process traceability, explicit priorities, dependencies and testable Given/When/Then acceptance criteria.

Definition of Ready and portfolio delivery-status principles prevent analysis artefacts from being incorrectly represented as implemented functionality.

Cross-cutting data, control, accessibility and non-functional requirements will be incorporated where relevant without unnecessarily duplicating requirements across Jira.

Automation and AI will remain separate from the core business capability, with the non-AI service established first.

The backlog framework is now ready for detailed H1 User Story creation.

34. EP-01 — Dispute Intake and Case Creation

EP-01 establishes the beginning of the PayFix AI 2.0 dispute lifecycle.

The Epic enables a customer to begin a payment dispute through an available standard route or an appropriate assisted route, creates an identifiable dispute case, captures relevant customer and transaction context and confirms successful submission with appropriate next-step information.

This Epic is part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and has no dependency on AI.

Information completeness assessment, classification, routing and ownership are intentionally handled in subsequent Epics rather than overloading the intake Epic.

34.1 EP-01 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-001, BR-002, BR-008, BR-009, BR-011
User	UR-CUS-001, UR-CUS-002, UR-CUS-005, UR-CUS-006
Functional	FR-001-FR-006
Data	DR-001, DR-003, DR-006-DR-010, DR-035
UX	UXR-001-UXR-006, UXR-016-UXR-020
Control	CR-016
NFR	NFR-005, NFR-006, NFR-008
Process	TB-01, TB-02

Not every requirement listed above must be repeated in every story. Each story references only the requirements materially relevant to its scope.

35. EP-01 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary User	Priority	Horizon	Status
----------	------------	--------------	----------	---------	--------

US-001	Initiate a Payment Dispute	Customer	Must	H1	Ready
US-002	Initiate a Dispute with Customer Service Assistance	Customer	Must	H1	Ready
US-003	Create a Unique Dispute Case	Customer	Must	H1	Ready
US-004	Capture Dispute Details and Transaction Context	Customer	Must	H1	Ready
US-005	Confirm Dispute Submission and Next Steps	Customer	Must	H1	Ready

36. EP-01 Requirement → Story Coverage

Requirement	Story Coverage
FR-001 Standard initiation	US-001
FR-002 Assisted initiation	US-002
FR-003 Case creation	US-003
FR-004 Customer/transaction linkage	US-004

FR-005 Original dispute information	US-004
FR-006 Submission confirmation	US-005
DR-001 Case ID	US-003
DR-003 Initiation timestamp	US-003
DR-006 Case reference consistency	US-003
DR-007–010 Intake context	US-002 / US-004
DR-035 Confirmation communication	US-005
UXR-001–004 Intake guidance	US-001 / US-004
UXR-005–006 Confirmation	US-005
UXR-016–020 Assisted route	US-002
CR-016 Human-supported route	US-002

All FR-001–FR-006 requirements now have an identified delivery story.

37. EP-01 Story → To-Be Process Traceability

Story	Process
US-001	TB-01.1 / TB-01.2
US-002	TB-01.2 / TB-01.3
US-003	TB-01.4 / TB-01.5
US-004	TB-02.1–TB-02.8
US-005	TB-01.6

18. Story Traceability Register

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
US-001	Your real Jira ID	EP-01	Customer	FR-001, UXR-001-004	TB-01	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-002	Your real Jira ID	EP-01	Customer / CS	FR-002, UXR-016-020, CR-016	TB-01	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-003	Your real Jira ID	EP-01	Customer	FR-003, DR-001/003/006	TB-01	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-004	Your real Jira ID	EP-01	Customer	FR-004/005, DR-007-010/048	TB-02	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-005	Your real Jira ID	EP-01	Customer	FR-006, DR-035, UXR - 005/006	TB-01	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
--------	-------------------	-------	----------	-------------------------------	-------	------	----	---------	---------	--------

38. EP-01 Story Boundary Review

US-001 vs US-002: These are not duplicates. US-001 covers standard dispute initiation, while US-002 covers assisted/human-supported dispute initiation.

US-003 vs US-004: These are not duplicates. US-003 establishes a stable dispute case identity, while US-004 records the initial customer and transaction information associated with that case.

US-004 vs future completeness story: These are not duplicates. US-004 captures available information, while a later story will assess whether the information required for the current stage is sufficient.

US-005 vs future communication stories: These are not duplicates. US-005 covers immediate submission confirmation, while EP-06 will later cover customer-action, ongoing status, specialist progress and final outcome communication.

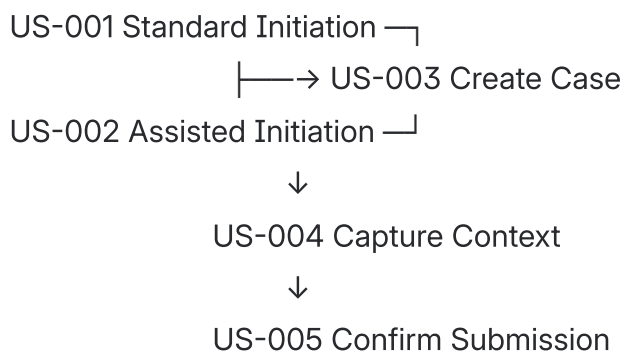
39. EP-01 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-001	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-002	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-003	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-004	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

US-005	Depends on US-003	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
--------	-------------------	-----	-----	-----	----------

A story can still be suitable where a genuine lifecycle dependency exists. Independence does not require pretending that related dispute-processing capabilities have no logical dependency.

40. EP-01 Story Dependencies



US-001 and US-002 provide alternative entry routes into the same controlled dispute lifecycle. Case identity is then established through US-003, relevant initial information is associated with the case through US-004, and successful submission is confirmed through US-005.

This represents logical dependency only and is not a committed Sprint sequence.

41. EP-01 Acceptance Coverage

Story	Main Acceptance Coverage
US-001	Standard initiation + understandable entry
US-002	Assisted initiation + human route
US-003	Case creation + Case ID + failed-creation integrity

US-004	Customer/transaction context + original information
US-005	Confirmation + next step + no false success

Detailed test cases are intentionally deferred. Current acceptance criteria establish the behavioural contract required for later functional, UX and UAT testing.

42. EP-01 Explicit Exclusions

EP-01 does not currently deliver:

- completeness assessment;
- missing-evidence request;
- classification;
- priority;
- routing;
- case ownership;
- investigation;
- specialist referral;
- Fraud decision;
- refund approval;
- final dispute decision;
- complaints;
- closure;
- AI summarisation;
- AI classification;
- automation optimisation.

These capabilities remain covered by later Epics and backlog stages.

43. BA Interpretation

EP-01 demonstrates the first conversion of the PayFix AI 2.0 requirements baseline into delivery-ready Agile User Stories.

Five stories have been created around distinct user and business outcomes rather than creating one Jira issue for each requirement.

The stories separate standard and assisted dispute initiation, case identity, information capture and submission confirmation while maintaining traceability to the Business, User, Functional, Data, UX and Control Requirements.

Acceptance criteria define observable behaviour without prescribing a particular interface, database, channel or implementation technology.

The assisted-service story ensures that the H1 dispute journey retains an appropriate human route, while the entire Epic remains independent of AI.

44. Conclusion

Five H1 User Stories have been created for EP-01 — Dispute Intake and Case Creation.

The stories cover standard dispute initiation, assisted Customer Service initiation, creation of an identifiable dispute case, capture of initial customer and transaction context and confirmation of successful submission with next-step information.

FR-001 through FR-006 now have delivery-story coverage, and the stories have been traced to their relevant Business, User, Data, UX and Control Requirements and To-Be process activities.

Each story has testable Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

The stories are therefore classified as Ready for future delivery refinement rather than falsely represented as implemented.

The next backlog stage will address completeness, classification, routing and ownership.

45. EP-02 — Classification, Routing and Ownership

EP-02 establishes the transition from initial dispute capture into controlled operational processing.

The Epic covers stage-appropriate information completeness, missing-information handling, customer-action state, deterministic classification, authorised classification exceptions, priority,

deterministic routing, manual routing fallback, initial ownership and controlled ownership transfer.

EP-02 forms part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and does not depend on AI.

The design uses deterministic rules where suitable while retaining authorised human review and override where information is ambiguous, incomplete or cannot be handled safely through standard logic.

45.1 EP-02 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-002, BR-003, BR-004, BR-005, BR-010, BR-012
User	UR-CUS-001, UR-CUS-004, UR-CS-001, UR-OPS-002, UR-OPS-003
Functional	FR-007–FR-019
Data	DR-014–DR-021, DR-024–DR-025, DR-041, DR-043
UX	UXR-002, UXR-004, UXR-008–UXR-009, UXR-012–UXR-015, UXR-029–UXR-030
Control	CR-005, CR-006, CR-007, CR-008, CR-012
NFR	NFR-011, NFR-013, NFR-015, NFR-017
Process	TB-03, TB-04, TB-05
Gateways	GW-02–GW-06
Overrides	OVR-01–OVR-04

EP-02 distinguishes standard deterministic processing from authorised exception handling. Rules are used where the required logic is sufficiently defined, while ambiguous or exceptional cases retain an accountable human route.

46. EP-02 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary User / Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
US-006	Assess Stage-Appropriate Information Completeness	Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-007	Request Missing Information and Track Customer Action	Customer / Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-008	Progress an Incomplete Case by Authorised Exception	Authorised Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-009	Classify a Dispute Using Defined Rules	Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog

US-010	Review and Correct an Ambiguous Classification	Authorised Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-011	Apply Dispute Priority	Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-012	Route a Dispute Using Defined Rules	Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-013	Manually Route a Case When Standard Routing Cannot Determine a Destination	Authorised Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-014	Assign Initial Case Ownership	Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog

US-015	Transfer Case Ownership with Handoff Context	Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog
--------	--	------------------	------	----	---------

47. EP-02 Requirement → Story Coverage

Functional Requirement	Story Coverage	Capability
FR-007	US-006	Assess stage-appropriate completeness
FR-008	US-007	Identify/request missing information
FR-009	US-008	Authorised incomplete-case exception
FR-010	US-007	Track customer action
FR-011	US-007	Continue after information receipt
FR-012	US-009	Deterministic classification
FR-013	US-010	Classification review/correction
FR-014	US-011	Apply priority
FR-015	US-012	Deterministic routing
FR-016	US-013	Manual routing exception
FR-017	US-014	Initial ownership
FR-018	US-015	Ownership transfer

FR-019	US-015	Handoff context
--------	--------	-----------------

Coverage Result: FR-007 through FR-019 now have identified delivery-story coverage within EP-02.

The mapping intentionally avoids creating one Story for every requirement where multiple closely related requirements contribute to a single coherent user or operational outcome.

47.1 Cross-Requirement Traceability

Story	Key Requirement Trace
US-006	BR-002; FR-007; DR-014; CR-005
US-007	BR-005/008; FR-008/010/011; DR-015-017; UXR-008/009/012/013
US-008	BR-002/012; FR-009; DR-014/015/043; CR-006/007/012
US-009	BR-003; FR-012; DR-041; CR-005
US-010	BR-003/012; FR-013; DR-041/043; CR-006/007/008/012
US-011	BR-003/010; FR-014; DR-018; CR-005/008
US-012	BR-003/004/010; FR-015; DR-019/020/041; CR-005/008
US-013	BR-003/004/012; FR-016; DR-019/020/043; CR-006/007/008/012
US-014	BR-004/010; FR-017; DR-021/022; CR-008
US-015	BR-004/010/011; FR-018/019; DR-024/025; UXR-029/030

48. EP-02 Story → To-Be Process Traceability

Story	To-Be Process / Decision Point
-------	--------------------------------

US-006	TB-03 — Completeness Assessment
US-007	TB-03 / TB-05 / TB-07 — Missing Information and Customer Action
US-008	TB-03 — Authorised Completeness Exception
US-009	TB-04 — Standard Classification
US-010	TB-04 — Classification Review / Override
US-011	TB-04 — Priority
US-012	TB-04 — Standard Routing
US-013	TB-04 / TB-05 — Manual Routing Exception
US-014	TB-05 — Establish Ownership
US-015	TB-05 — Ownership Transfer and Handoff

EP-02 converts the To-Be completeness, classification, routing and ownership activities into discrete backlog items while maintaining the distinction between standard deterministic processing and controlled human exception paths.

18. Story Traceability Register

Story ID	Jira ID	Epic	User / Role	Requirement Links	Process	Priority	Horizon	Status	AC Status	Test Link
----------	---------	------	-------------	-------------------	---------	----------	---------	--------	-----------	-----------

US-006	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Operational User	FR-007, DR-014, CR-005	TB-03	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-007	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Customer / Ops	FR-008/010/011, DR-015-017	TB-03/05/07	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-008	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Authorised Ops	FR-009, CR-006/007/012	TB-03	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-009	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Operational User	FR-012, DR-041, CR-005	TB-04	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-010	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Authorised Ops	FR-013, DR-041/043, CR-006/007/008/012	TB-04	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

US-011	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Operational User	FR-014, DR-018	TB-04	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-012	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Operational User	FR-015, DR-019/020/041	TB-04	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-013	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Authorised Ops	FR-016, DR-019/020/043	TB-04/05	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-014	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Operational User	FR-017, DR-021/022	TB-05	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future
US-015	Real Jira ID	EP-02	Operational User	FR-018/019, DR-024/025	TB-05	Must	H1	Backlog	Defined	Future

49. EP-02 Story Boundary Review

US-006 vs US-007: US-006 determines whether the current-stage information is sufficiently complete. US-007 manages the customer-action process where required information is missing.

US-007 vs US-008: US-007 obtains missing information through the standard path. US-008 provides a controlled authorised exception where an incomplete case may legitimately progress.

US-009 vs US-010: US-009 covers deterministic classification using defined rules. US-010 covers authorised human review and correction where classification is ambiguous or unsuitable.

US-011 vs US-009: Classification describes the nature/type of the dispute. Priority describes the relative processing urgency or handling priority. They are separate business concepts.

US-012 vs US-013: US-012 covers deterministic routing. US-013 covers the controlled human routing path where standard routing cannot determine an appropriate destination.

US-012/US-013 vs US-014: Routing determines the operational destination. US-014 establishes accountable ownership for progressing the case.

US-014 vs US-015: US-014 establishes initial ownership. US-015 governs transfer of that ownership and the associated handoff context.

US-015 vs future specialist referral: Ownership transfer within operational processing is not treated as the same capability as formal specialist referral and return, which will be addressed in a subsequent Epic.

50. EP-02 Logical Story Dependencies

EP-01 Intake



US-006 Assess Completeness



Information incomplete



US-007 Request Missing Information

US-008 Authorised Exception



US-009 Standard Classification

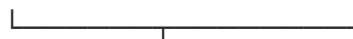


ambiguity / correction?



No

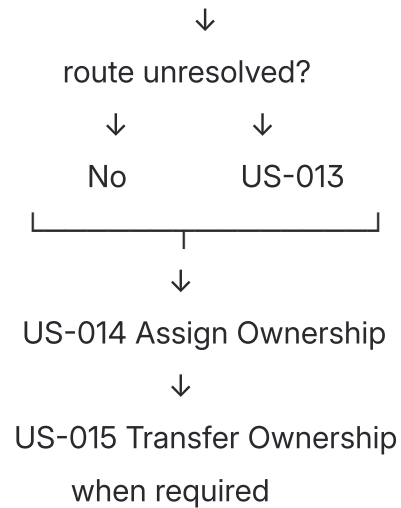
US-010



US-011 Apply Priority



US-012 Standard Routing



his diagram represents **logical capability dependencies only**. It is not a committed Sprint sequence, implementation plan or fixed technical workflow.

Standard paths and exception paths are deliberately separated so that deterministic processing does not eliminate accountable human intervention.

51. EP-02 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-006	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-007	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-008	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-009	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-010	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-011	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-012	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-013	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-014	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-015	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The stories have genuine lifecycle dependencies but remain independently understandable and testable business capabilities. INVEST independence is therefore interpreted pragmatically

rather than pretending that completeness, classification, routing and ownership have no relationship.

52. EP-02 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Stories	Acceptance Focus
Completeness	US-006	Stage-appropriate information sufficiency
Missing information	US-007	Request, customer action, receipt and continuation
Completeness exception	US-008	Authorisation, reason and auditability
Classification	US-009	Deterministic standard classification
Classification exception	US-010	Human review, correction and override traceability
Priority	US-011	Defined and traceable priority logic
Routing	US-012	Deterministic operational routing
Routing exception	US-013	Controlled manual routing
Initial ownership	US-014	Explicit accountable owner
Ownership transfer	US-015	Traceable transfer and handoff context

Acceptance criteria are expressed as observable business behaviour rather than technical implementation instructions. Detailed system test cases, integration tests and UAT scenarios will be developed later under the Testing and UAT workstream.

53. EP-02 Explicit Exclusions

EP-02 does not currently deliver:

- detailed dispute investigation;
- final evidence sufficiency decisions;
- specialist referral and specialist return;
- Fraud decision-making;
- refund approval;
- final dispute outcome;
- complaint handling;
- closure;
- AI classification;
- AI routing;
- AI prioritisation;
- AI handoff summarisation;
- workforce optimisation;
- queue-capacity forecasting.

These capabilities remain in later delivery packages and Epics.

54. BA Interpretation

EP-02 demonstrates decomposition of a complex operational process into standard-path, exception-path and accountability-focused User Stories.

The backlog separates completeness, customer action, classification, priority, routing and ownership rather than treating them as a single workflow capability.

Deterministic rule-based behaviour is explicitly separated from authorised human review and override. This ensures that automation of standard operational decisions does not remove appropriate human accountability for ambiguous or exceptional cases.

The Story set also addresses operational concerns identified during discovery, particularly handoffs, unclear ownership, waiting and rework, while avoiding unsupported claims that the proposed changes will automatically eliminate those issues.

Each Story remains traceable to the requirements baseline and To-Be process design, and its acceptance criteria define expected business behaviour without prescribing a specific software implementation.

55. Conclusion

Ten H1 User Stories have been created for EP-02 — Classification, Routing and Ownership.

The Stories cover stage-appropriate completeness assessment, missing-information handling, authorised incomplete-case progression, deterministic classification, classification review, priority, deterministic routing, manual routing, initial ownership and controlled ownership transfer.

FR-007 through FR-019 now have identified backlog coverage.

Standard deterministic behaviour and authorised human exception paths have been deliberately separated to maintain control, traceability and accountability.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

US-006 through US-015 are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement** rather than represented as implemented.

The next backlog stage will address investigation, evidence handling and specialist referral/review.

56. EP-03 — Investigation and Evidence Management

EP-03 establishes the controlled investigation and evidence-management stage of the PayFix AI 2.0 dispute lifecycle.

The Epic enables an appropriately owned dispute to progress through investigation using relevant case, transaction and evidence information while maintaining traceability of investigation activity, evidence provenance, customer-action requirements and case progress.

EP-03 forms part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and must operate independently of AI.

Evidence summarisation remains a later controlled AI-pilot candidate and is deliberately excluded from this Epic. The original source evidence and accountable human investigation remain authoritative.

56.1 EP-03 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-005, BR-010, BR-011
Functional	FR-020–FR-026
User	Operational investigation and customer evidence needs from the Requirements Baseline
Data	Case, transaction, evidence, event and investigation traceability requirements
UX	Clear evidence/action requirements and operational investigation context
Control	Evidence provenance, accountable activity and controlled progression
Process	TB-06 — Investigation and TB-07 — Additional Information / Evidence
Horizon	H1 — Core Process Foundation
AI	No dependency; AI evidence summarisation excluded

Detailed requirement-to-story traceability will be added as the EP-03 User Stories are created. This avoids assigning requirements to Stories before the Story boundaries and acceptance criteria have been defined.

57. EP-03 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary User / Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
----------	------------	---------------------	----------	---------	--------

US-016	Review Case Context and Begin Investigation	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Ready
US-017	Record Investigation Activity and Findings	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Ready
US-018	Capture and Associate Evidence with a Dispute Case	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Ready
US-019	Request Additional Evidence During Investigation	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Ready
US-020	Track Evidence Request and Record Receipt	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Ready

US-021	Maintain Investigation Progress and Waiting State	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Ready
US-022	Complete Investigation and Identify Next Processing Stage	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Ready

Coverage Result: FR-020 through FR-026 now have identified delivery-story coverage within EP-03.

The stories deliberately separate case review, investigation activity, evidence capture, evidence request, evidence receipt, waiting-state management and investigation completion rather than combining the entire investigation lifecycle into one oversized backlog item.

58.1 Cross-Requirement Traceability

Story	Key Requirement Trace
US-016	BR-010/011; FR-020; TB-06
US-017	BR-010/011; FR-021; TB-06
US-018	BR-005/011; FR-022; DR-011-013; TB-06
US-019	BR-005/010; FR-023; UXR-008/009/012/013/015; TB-06/07
US-020	BR-005/010/011; FR-024; DR-011-013/015-017; TB-07
US-021	BR-010/011; FR-025; TB-06/07

US-022	BR-010/011; FR-026; TB-06
--------	---------------------------

59. EP-03 Story → To-Be Process Traceability

Story	To-Be Process
US-016	TB-06 — Enter Investigation / Review Case Context
US-017	TB-06 — Conduct and Record Investigation
US-018	TB-06 — Capture Evidence
US-019	TB-06 / TB-07 — Identify and Request Additional Evidence
US-020	TB-07 — Track Request / Receive Evidence
US-021	TB-06 / TB-07 — Maintain Active / Waiting State
US-022	TB-06 — Complete Investigation / Progress to Next Stage

EP-03 converts the To-Be investigation and evidence activities into discrete delivery stories while retaining the distinction between source evidence, operational findings, customer action, waiting states and investigation completion.

60. EP-03 Story Boundary Review

US-016 vs US-017: US-016 enables the investigator to understand the existing case context and enter investigation. US-017 records material investigation activity and findings produced during investigation.

US-017 vs US-018: Investigation findings are operational interpretations developed during investigation, while evidence represents source information or material used to support investigation.

US-018 vs US-019: US-018 captures evidence that exists or has been received. US-019 creates a new investigation-stage request where additional evidence is required.

US-019 vs US-020: US-019 creates the evidence request. US-020 tracks whether the request remains outstanding and records receipt where evidence is subsequently supplied.

US-020 vs evidence sufficiency: Receipt of evidence does not automatically mean the evidence is sufficient for investigation or final decision.

US-021 vs US-022: US-021 maintains the investigation's active or waiting state. US-022 controls the point where the current investigation stage is legitimately completed and the case progresses.

US-022 vs final decision: Investigation completion is not the final dispute outcome and does not bypass later specialist, approval or decision controls.

61. EP-03 Logical Story Dependencies

EP-02 Ownership Established



US-016 Review Case Context



US-017 Record Investigation Activity



US-018 Capture / Associate Evidence



Additional evidence required?



Yes



US-019 Request Evidence



US-020 Track / Receive



No



US-021 Maintain Active / Waiting State



US-022 Complete Investigation



Next Appropriate Processing Stage

This represents **logical capability dependency only** and is not a committed Sprint sequence or technical implementation design.

Investigation may iterate between activity, evidence handling and waiting states. The diagram therefore simplifies the lifecycle for backlog traceability rather than representing every possible process loop.

62. EP-03 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-016	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-017	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-018	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-019	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-020	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-021	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-022	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The stories have logical investigation dependencies but remain independently understandable and testable. INVEST independence is therefore applied pragmatically to business capability boundaries rather than interpreted as complete lifecycle isolation.

63. EP-03 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Story	Acceptance Focus
Investigation entry	US-016	Relevant case and transaction context
Investigation record	US-017	Activity, findings, accountability and history

Evidence capture	US-018	Association, provenance and evidence integrity
Evidence request	US-019	Specific, understandable and traceable request
Evidence receipt	US-020	Request state, receipt and provenance
Investigation state	US-021	Active vs waiting and waiting reason
Investigation completion	US-022	Controlled exit and next-stage identification

Acceptance criteria establish observable business behaviour for investigation and evidence management. Detailed system, integration and UAT test cases will be created later under the Testing and UAT workstream.

64. EP-03 Explicit Exclusions

EP-03 does not currently deliver:

- specialist referral execution;
- specialist review;
- Fraud decision-making;
- refund approval;
- final dispute outcome;
- complaint handling;
- case closure;
- AI evidence summarisation;
- AI investigation recommendations;
- automated evidence interpretation;
- predictive investigation prioritisation;

- workforce optimisation.

These capabilities remain in later Epics and delivery horizons.

65. BA Interpretation

EP-03 demonstrates decomposition of the investigation lifecycle into distinct operational, data and control capabilities.

The backlog separates existing case context, investigation activity, source evidence, evidence requests, evidence receipt, waiting states and investigation completion rather than treating investigation as a single undifferentiated workflow.

Particular emphasis has been placed on information-state integrity. Requested evidence is not treated as received, received evidence is not automatically treated as sufficient, investigation findings remain distinguishable from source evidence, and investigation completion does not represent the final dispute decision.

These distinctions improve traceability and provide a stronger basis for later process measurement, testing, auditability and controlled automation.

EP-03 also remains independent of AI. Any later AI evidence summarisation capability must operate as an assistive layer and must not replace source evidence or accountable human investigation.

66. EP-03 Conclusion

Seven H1 User Stories have been created for EP-03 — Investigation and Evidence Management.

The Stories cover investigation entry, investigation activity and findings, evidence capture, investigation-stage evidence requests, evidence receipt tracking, active/waiting investigation states and controlled investigation completion.

FR-020 through FR-026 now have identified backlog coverage.

The Story set preserves clear distinctions between evidence, investigation findings, evidence-request state, evidence receipt, evidence sufficiency and final decision-making.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

US-016 through US-022 are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement** rather than represented as implemented.

The next backlog stage will address specialist referral and specialist review under EP-04.

67. EP-04 — Specialist Referral and Review

EP-04 establishes the controlled specialist-referral and specialist-review stage of the PayFix AI 2.0 dispute lifecycle.

The Epic supports cases that require specialist expertise, authority or review outside the standard investigation path.

The design requires specialist referral to be explicit and traceable, with sufficient relevant context transferred to the receiving specialist function. Specialist activity, findings and return/progression outcomes must remain attributable and distinguishable from the original investigation and later final decision process.

EP-04 forms part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and must operate independently of AI.

AI-generated handoff or evidence summaries remain later controlled-pilot candidates and must not replace specialist judgement or accountable human decision-making.

67.1 EP-04 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-006, BR-010, BR-011
Functional	FR-027–FR-033
User	Specialist, Fraud, Finance, Technical and operational referral needs from the Requirements Baseline
Data	Specialist referral, ownership, handoff, finding and return traceability
UX	Sufficient transfer context and reduced unnecessary reconstruction
Control	Authorised specialist handling, accountability, traceability and return/progression control
Process	TB-08 — Specialist Referral, TB-09 — Specialist Review

Horizon	H1 — Core Process Foundation
AI	No dependency; AI-generated specialist decisions excluded

Detailed requirement-to-story traceability will be added as the EP-04 User Stories are created. Story boundaries will distinguish referral, acceptance, specialist review, specialist findings and controlled return/progression rather than combining the entire specialist lifecycle into one backlog item.

68. EP-04 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary User / Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
US-023	Refer a Dispute for Specialist Review	Operational Investigator	Must	H1	Backlog
US-024	Accept Specialist Referral and Establish Specialist Ownership	Specialist User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-025	Review Specialist Case Context and Evidence	Specialist User	Must	H1	Backlog

US-026	Record Specialist Review Activity and Findings	Specialist User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-027	Request Additional Information During Specialist Review	Specialist User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-028	Track Specialist Information Request and Record Response	Specialist User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-029	Complete Specialist Review and Return or Progress the Case	Specialist User	Must	H1	Backlog

69. EP-04 Requirement → Story Coverage

Functional Requirement	Story Coverage	Capability
FR-027	US-023	Create controlled specialist referral

FR-028	US-024	Accept referral and establish specialist ownership
FR-029	US-025	Review referral context, case history and evidence
FR-030	US-026	Record specialist activity and findings
FR-031	US-027	Request additional specialist information
FR-032	US-028	Track specialist request and response
FR-033	US-029	Complete specialist review and return/progress case

Coverage Result: FR-027 through FR-033 now have identified delivery-story coverage within EP-04.

The specialist lifecycle has deliberately been decomposed into referral, acceptance, context review, specialist activity, information request, response tracking and controlled specialist completion rather than represented as one oversized backlog item.

69.1 Cross-Requirement Traceability

Story	Key Requirement Trace
US-023	BR-006/010/011; FR-027; DR-026/027; UXR-029/030; CR-008/012
US-024	BR-006/010/011; FR-028; DR-028/029; CR-008/012
US-025	BR-006/010/011; FR-029; DR-030/031; UXR-029/030; CR-008/012

US-026	BR-006/010/011; FR-030; DR-030/031; CR-008/012
US-027	BR-005/006/010; FR-031; UXR-008/009/012/013/015/030
US-028	BR-005/006/010/011; FR-032; UXR-008/009/012/013/030
US-029	BR-006/010/011; FR-033; DR-030/031; CR-008/012

70. EP-04 Story → To-Be Process Traceability

Story	To-Be Process
US-023	TB-08 — Create Specialist Referral
US-024	TB-08 / TB-09 — Accept Referral and Establish Specialist Ownership
US-025	TB-09 — Review Specialist Context and Evidence
US-026	TB-09 — Perform and Record Specialist Review
US-027	TB-09 — Request Additional Specialist Information
US-028	TB-09 — Track Request / Receive Response
US-029	TB-09 — Complete Specialist Review / Return or Progress

EP-04 converts the specialist-referral and review process into discrete delivery stories while maintaining clear distinctions between referral creation, acceptance, ownership, specialist findings, information-request states and specialist-review completion.

71. EP-04 Story Boundary Review

US-023 vs US-024: US-023 creates and sends the specialist referral. US-024 confirms specialist acceptance and establishes accountable specialist ownership.

US-024 vs US-025: Acceptance establishes responsibility for specialist handling. US-025 enables the specialist to review the relevant case context and evidence before performing material specialist work.

US-025 vs US-026: US-025 reviews existing information. US-026 records specialist activities and findings produced during specialist review.

US-026 vs source evidence: Specialist findings remain operational interpretations and are not treated as the same thing as underlying source evidence.

US-027 vs US-028: US-027 creates a specialist-stage information or evidence request. US-028 tracks the outstanding request and records the response when received.

US-028 vs specialist sufficiency: Receipt of a requested response does not automatically mean the specialist has sufficient information or that the review is complete.

US-029 vs final decision: US-029 controls completion of specialist review and the handoff to the next appropriate stage. It does not automatically represent the final dispute decision, refund approval or case closure.

72. EP-04 Logical Story Dependencies

EP-03 Investigation Complete

↓

US-023 Create Specialist Referral

↓

US-024 Accept Referral / Establish Ownership

↓

US-025 Review Context and Evidence

↓

US-026 Record Specialist Activity / Findings

↓

Additional specialist information required?

↓

Yes

↓

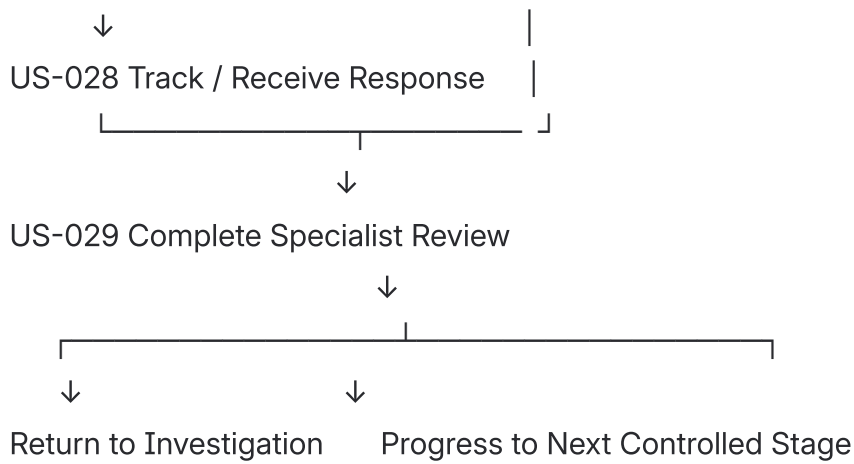
US-027 Request Information

↓

No

|

|



This represents **logical capability dependencies only** and is not a committed Sprint sequence or detailed technical workflow.

Specialist review may iterate between findings, information requests and additional review activity. The diagram therefore simplifies the lifecycle for backlog traceability while preserving the main control points.

73. EP-04 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-023	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-024	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-025	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-026	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-027	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-028	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-029	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The specialist Stories have genuine lifecycle dependencies but remain independently understandable and testable business capabilities. INVEST independence is therefore applied pragmatically to coherent specialist outcomes rather than interpreted as complete process isolation.

74. EP-04 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Story	Acceptance Focus
Specialist referral	US-023	Referral need, destination, reason, handoff and traceability
Specialist acceptance	US-024	Acceptance, ownership and accountable transition
Specialist context review	US-025	Case history, evidence and controlled access
Specialist activity	US-026	Findings, accountability, history and information distinctions
Specialist information request	US-027	Specific and traceable request
Specialist response tracking	US-028	Outstanding state, receipt, provenance and request relationship
Specialist completion	US-029	Controlled completion, return/progression and handoff

Acceptance criteria define observable specialist-process behaviour without prescribing a particular user interface, workflow engine, database implementation or specialist organisational structure.

Detailed system test cases and UAT scenarios will be developed later under the Testing and UAT workstream.

75. EP-04 Explicit Exclusions

EP-04 does not currently deliver:

- final dispute decision;
- refund approval;
- final Fraud decision outside the applicable later authority model;
- complaint resolution;
- final customer outcome communication;
- case closure;
- autonomous specialist decision-making;
- AI-generated specialist findings;
- AI-generated specialist decisions;
- AI-generated handoff summaries;
- AI evidence summarisation.

These capabilities remain within later Epics or controlled future delivery horizons.

76. BA Interpretation

EP-04 demonstrates decomposition of the specialist lifecycle into distinct referral, ownership, review, information and control capabilities.

The backlog explicitly distinguishes referral creation from referral acceptance, and specialist ownership from specialist review completion. This avoids treating a handoff as proof that the receiving function has accepted responsibility or completed its work.

The specialist information model also distinguishes source evidence, operational investigation findings, specialist findings and final decisions. Information requested during specialist review is not treated as received until an actual response is captured, and receipt does not automatically establish sufficiency.

Controlled human authority remains central to specialist processing. The H1 specialist capability is therefore independent of AI and does not permit AI to replace specialist judgement or sensitive decision authority.

The resulting Story set provides traceability from requirements through the To-Be specialist process and creates a stronger foundation for later data design, audit controls and UAT.

77. Conclusion

Seven H1 User Stories have been created for EP-04 — Specialist Referral and Review.

The Stories cover specialist referral, specialist acceptance and ownership, context and evidence review, specialist activity and findings, additional specialist information requests, response tracking and controlled specialist completion.

FR-027 through FR-033 now have identified backlog coverage.

The Story set preserves clear distinctions between referral, acceptance, ownership, specialist findings, requested information, received information, specialist completion and final dispute decision-making.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

US-023 through US-029 are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement** rather than represented as implemented.

The next backlog stage will address controlled decisions, approvals and case closure.

78. EP-05 — Decision and Approval Controls

EP-05 establishes the controlled decision and approval stage of the PayFix AI 2.0 dispute lifecycle.

The Epic supports the transition from completed investigation and, where applicable, specialist review into an accountable business decision.

Decision-making must use relevant case, investigation, evidence and specialist context while preserving the identity or authorised role responsible for the decision, the decision rationale and any required approval state.

Sensitive customer-impacting decisions remain subject to appropriate human authority. In particular, Fraud outcomes, refund approvals and other controlled decisions must not be delegated to autonomous AI.

EP-05 forms part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and must therefore operate independently of AI.

Customer outcome communication, complaint handling and final case closure are deliberately handled in subsequent Epics rather than being combined with the decision-control capability.

78.1 EP-05 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-007, BR-011
Functional	FR-034–FR-038
User	Operational, Fraud and Finance decision/approval needs from the Requirements Baseline
Data	Decision, rationale, authority, approval and decision-event traceability
Control	Human decision authority, approval controls, override traceability and separation of responsibilities where applicable
Process	TB-10 — Decision / Approval
Horizon	H1 — Core Process Foundation
AI	No dependency; autonomous sensitive decisions prohibited

Detailed requirement-to-story traceability will be added as the EP-05 User Stories are created.

The Story design will distinguish decision preparation, decision recording, controlled approval and exception or override handling rather than treating all decision activity as one undifferentiated backlog item.

Decision Authority Principle: The system may support an authorised user with relevant information, rules and traceability, but it must not silently convert an investigation finding, specialist finding or automated output into an approved customer-impacting decision. Required human authority and approval remain explicit process controls.

79. EP-05 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary User / Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
US-030	Review Decision-Ready Case Context	Authorised Decision-Maker	Must	H1	Backlog
US-031	Record an Authorised Dispute Decision and Rationale	Authorised Decision-Maker	Must	H1	Backlog
US-032	Apply Required Decision Approval	Authorised Approver	Must	H1	Backlog
US-033	Amend or Override a Decision Through a Controlled Process	Authorised Decision User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-034	Finalise Decision State and Prepare for Customer Outcome Communication	Authorised Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog

80. EP-05 Requirement → Story Coverage

Functional Requirement	Story Coverage	Capability
FR-034	US-030	Review decision-ready case context
FR-035	US-031	Record authorised decision and rationale
FR-036	US-032	Apply required decision approval
FR-037	US-033	Controlled decision amendment / override
FR-038	US-034	Finalise controlled decision state

Coverage Result: FR-034 through FR-038 now have identified delivery-story coverage within EP-05.

Decision review, decision recording, approval, controlled amendment and finalisation have deliberately been separated so that a recorded decision is not incorrectly treated as approved or communicated merely because earlier processing has completed.

80.1 Cross-Requirement Traceability

Story	Key Requirement Trace
US-030	BR-007/011; FR-034; CR-001-004; TB-10
US-031	BR-007/011; FR-035; DR-032/033/034; CR-001-004/009
US-032	BR-007/011; FR-036; CR-001-004/009/010
US-033	BR-007/011; FR-037; DR-032/033/034; CR-007/009/010/012

US-034	BR-007/011; FR-038; DR-032/033/034/036; CR-001-004/009/010
--------	--

81. EP-05 Story → To-Be Process Traceability

Story	To-Be Process
US-030	TB-10 — Review Decision Context
US-031	TB-10 — Record Decision and Rationale
US-032	TB-10 — Apply Required Approval
US-033	TB-10 — Controlled Decision Amendment / Override
US-034	TB-10 / TB-11 — Complete Decision State / Prepare Outcome Communication

EP-05 converts the To-Be decision and approval stage into discrete controlled backlog items while preserving the distinction between review, decision, approval, amendment and finalisation.

82. EP-05 Story Boundary Review

US-030 vs US-031: US-030 reviews the relevant information required for decision-making. US-031 records the actual authorised business decision and rationale.

US-031 vs US-032: US-031 creates the decision record. US-032 applies an additional approval control where the authority model requires one.

US-032 vs US-033: US-032 approves, declines or returns a recorded decision. US-033 governs a later material amendment or override while preserving the previous decision history.

US-033 vs ordinary editing: A controlled decision amendment is not equivalent to simply editing a field. Material decision history, reason, accountable actor and approval implications remain traceable.

US-034 vs US-032: Approval may be one prerequisite for finalising the decision state. US-034 determines that all applicable decision and approval activity has reached an appropriate resolved state.

US-034 vs customer communication: Decision finalisation makes the authorised outcome available for later communication. It does not prove that the customer has been informed.

US-034 vs closure: Completion of decision processing does not automatically close the dispute.

83. EP-05 Logical Story Dependencies

Investigation / Specialist Processing Complete



US-030 Review Decision-Ready Context



US-031 Record Decision + Rationale



Additional approval required?



Yes



US-032 Apply Required Approval



Declined / returned?



Yes



US-033 Amend / Override



US-034 Finalise Controlled Decision State



Customer Outcome Communication

This diagram represents **logical capability dependencies only**. It is not a committed Sprint sequence or detailed system workflow.

Decision and approval activity may iterate where a decision is returned, amended or requires renewed approval. The simplified view is used for backlog traceability.

84. EP-05 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-030	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-031	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-032	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-033	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-034	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The Stories have genuine decision-lifecycle dependencies but remain independently understandable and testable business capabilities. INVEST independence is therefore applied pragmatically to coherent decision and control outcomes.

85. EP-05 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Story	Acceptance Focus
Decision review	US-030	Relevant context, authority and unresolved dependencies
Decision recording	US-031	Decision, rationale, actor, timing and traceability
Decision approval	US-032	Approval authority, approve/decline path and separation from decision

Decision amendment	US-033	Controlled change, preserved history and renewed approval where required
Decision finalisation	US-034	Resolved decision state and readiness for communication

Acceptance criteria establish observable decision and control behaviour rather than prescribing a particular rules engine, workflow engine, interface or technical approval implementation.

Detailed system, integration and UAT scenarios will be developed later under the Testing and UAT workstream.

86. EP-05 Explicit Exclusions

EP-05 does not currently deliver:

- customer outcome communication;
- customer status updates;
- complaint handling;
- complaint escalation;
- refund execution;
- final case closure;
- autonomous AI decision-making;
- autonomous refund approval;
- autonomous Fraud decision-making;
- autonomous decision override;
- AI-generated final authority.

These capabilities remain within later Epics or controlled future delivery horizons.

87. BA Interpretation

EP-05 demonstrates decomposition of a sensitive decision lifecycle into distinct review, decision, approval, amendment and finalisation capabilities.

The backlog deliberately avoids treating an investigation finding, specialist finding, rule result or AI output as an approved customer-impacting outcome.

The design preserves explicit human authority for sensitive decisions and distinguishes the decision-maker from any separate approver where the applicable control model requires additional approval.

Material decision amendments are handled through a controlled change path rather than silently overwriting previous decisions. This preserves decision history, rationale, accountability and any requirement to reassess approval.

The resulting Story set provides a clear basis for later UAT of decision authority, approval controls, negative paths, override behaviour and audit traceability while remaining independent of any particular implementation technology.

88. Conclusion

Five H1 User Stories have been created for EP-05 — Decision and Approval Controls.

The Stories cover decision-context review, recording of an authorised decision and rationale, required approval, controlled amendment or override and finalisation of the decision state before customer outcome communication.

FR-034 through FR-038 now have identified backlog coverage.

The Story set preserves clear distinctions between investigation findings, specialist findings, recorded decisions, approval states, controlled amendments, decision finalisation and customer communication.

Human authority remains explicit for sensitive customer-impacting outcomes, and automated or AI-generated outputs cannot independently satisfy required decision or approval controls.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

US-030 through US-034 are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement** rather than represented as implemented.

The next backlog stage will address customer status, communication and assisted support under EP-06.

89. EP-06 — Customer Status, Communication and Assisted Support

EP-06 establishes the customer-facing status, communication and assisted-support capabilities of the PayFix AI 2.0 dispute lifecycle.

The Epic enables customers to understand the current position of their dispute, whether action is required from them, relevant progress during processing and the authorised outcome once

applicable decision controls have completed.

Communication must reflect the actual controlled state of the dispute rather than presenting assumptions or internal workflow activity as customer-facing facts.

The Epic also retains an appropriate human-supported route for customers who cannot reasonably use the standard service route or who require additional assistance.

Accessibility, clarity and minimisation of unnecessary customer effort are treated as cross-cutting service-design concerns rather than optional interface enhancements.

EP-06 forms part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and therefore operates independently of AI.

AI-assisted communication drafting may be explored only in a later controlled horizon and must not invent case facts, decisions, customer obligations or outcome information.

89.1 EP-06 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-008, BR-009, BR-011
Functional	FR-039–FR-043
User	Customer status, action, assistance and communication needs from the Requirements Baseline
Data	Case status, customer-action, communication and authorised-outcome traceability
UX	Clear status, understandable next actions, accessibility, assisted support and understandable outcomes
Control	Communication reflects controlled case state; no false outcome or action information

Process	TB-11 — Customer Outcome Communication, plus customer communication touchpoints across the lifecycle
Horizon	H1 — Core Process Foundation
AI	No dependency; autonomous customer communication excluded

Detailed requirement-to-story traceability will be added as the EP-06 User Stories are created.

Story boundaries will distinguish current-status communication, customer-action communication, progress communication, final authorised outcome communication and assisted support rather than combining all customer interaction into one oversized Story.

Customer Communication Principle: Customer-facing information must be based on the actual controlled case state and should communicate what the customer reasonably needs to understand or do next. Internal operational terminology, speculative conclusions and unapproved outcomes should not be presented as established customer-facing facts.

Assisted Support Principle: The availability of self-service does not remove the need for an appropriate human-supported route. Customers who need assistance should be able to progress without being required to disclose or prove unrelated personal characteristics merely to access support.

90. EP-06 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary User / Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
US-035	View Current Dispute Status and Next Step	Customer	Must	H1	Backlog

US-036	Understand When Customer Action Is Required	Customer	Must	H1	Backlog
US-037	Receive Meaningful Dispute Progress Updates	Customer	Must	H1	Backlog
US-038	Receive the Final Authorised Dispute Outcome	Customer	Must	H1	Backlog
US-039	Access Human-Assisted and Accessible Dispute Support	Customer	Must	H1	Backlog

91. EP-06 Requirement → Story Coverage

Functional Requirement	Story	Capability
FR-039	US-035	Current meaningful dispute status
FR-040	US-036	Customer-action communication
FR-041	US-037	Meaningful progress updates

FR-042	US-038	Final authorised outcome communication
FR-043	US-039	Human-assisted and accessible support

Coverage Result: FR-039 through FR-043 now have identified delivery-story coverage within EP-06.

Current status, customer action, progress communication, final outcome communication and assisted support have deliberately been separated because they represent different customer needs and different controlled case states.

91.1 Cross-Requirement Traceability

Story	Key Requirement Trace
US-035	BR-008/011; UR-CUS-003; FR-039
US-036	BR-008/009/011; UR-CUS-004/005; FR-040; UXR-008/009/012/013
US-037	BR-008/011; UR-CUS-003/008; FR-041; UXR-005/006/023/024
US-038	BR-008/011; UR-CUS-009; FR-042; DR-036/037; UXR-023-028
US-039	BR-008/009/011; UR-CUS-005/006; FR-043; UXR-016-022; CR-016

92. EP-06 Story → To-Be Process Traceability

Story	To-Be Process / Touchpoint
US-035	Cross-lifecycle Customer Status
US-036	Customer-Action Touchpoints across TB-03, TB-07 and TB-09

US-037	Cross-lifecycle Material Progress Communication
US-038	TB-11 — Customer Outcome Communication
US-039	Cross-lifecycle Assisted / Accessible Support Route

EP-06 operates across several To-Be lifecycle stages rather than existing as one isolated process step. Customer-facing communication is therefore traced both to TB-11 and to relevant customer touchpoints created by completeness, investigation and specialist-processing activities.

93. EP-06 Customer Communication State Model

Communication Concept	Meaning
Current Status	Meaningful representation of where the dispute currently is
Customer Action	A specific valid action currently required from the customer
Progress Update	A material lifecycle change worth communicating
Final Outcome	Authorised dispute outcome after applicable decision controls
Assisted Support	Human-supported route for understanding or progressing the dispute
Case Closure	Separate lifecycle control outside EP-06

These communication concepts must remain distinct. For example, a customer may have a dispute that is **Under Investigation** while having **No Customer Action Required**.

Likewise, a final decision may exist before the customer has actually been informed, and customer outcome communication may occur before final administrative case closure.

94. EP-06 Story Boundary Review

US-035 vs US-036: US-035 communicates where the dispute currently is. US-036 communicates whether the customer needs to take a specific action and what that action is.

US-035 vs US-037: US-035 supports current-status understanding. US-037 communicates meaningful changes or milestones during processing.

US-036 vs underlying evidence-request Stories: US-036 does not create the underlying request. It communicates an existing controlled customer-action requirement originating from completeness, investigation or specialist processing.

US-037 vs every internal event: A customer progress update is not required for every system or operational event. Only meaningful customer-relevant progress should be surfaced.

US-037 vs US-038: US-037 communicates progress while processing remains active. US-038 communicates the final authorised outcome once the applicable decision controls have completed.

US-038 vs case closure: Outcome communication does not by itself close the case.

US-039 vs US-002: US-002 provides assisted initiation. US-039 extends appropriate assisted and accessible support across later customer-facing stages of the dispute lifecycle.

US-039 vs decision authority: A support user may explain an authorised outcome but does not gain authority to change that outcome merely by providing support.

95. EP-06 Logical Story Dependencies

Controlled Dispute Lifecycle

↓

US-035 Current Status

|

|— Customer action required?

|

↓

|

US-036

|

|— Meaningful progress?

|

↓

|

US-037

|

|— Final authorised decision complete?



US-038

US-039 Human-Assisted / Accessible Support

applies across relevant customer touchpoints

This represents logical customer-communication relationships only and is not a committed Sprint sequence or channel design.

US-039 is cross-cutting and may support the customer at multiple points rather than occurring as a single sequential process step.

96. EP-06 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-035	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-036	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-037	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-038	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-039	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The Stories rely on controlled lifecycle states from other Epics but remain independently understandable and testable customer outcomes. INVEST independence is therefore applied pragmatically to customer-facing capability boundaries.

97. EP-06 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Story	Acceptance Focus
Current status	US-035	Meaningful, controlled and understandable status

Customer action	US-036	Required action, clarity and action-state integrity
Progress updates	US-037	Material progress without excessive communication
Final outcome	US-038	Authorised, understandable and traceable outcome
Assisted support	US-039	Human support, accessibility and controlled-case consistency

Acceptance criteria define observable customer and service behaviour without prescribing a specific mobile application, website, contact-centre platform, notification technology or communication channel.

Detailed UX validation, accessibility testing, system testing and UAT scenarios will be developed later.

98. EP-06 Explicit Exclusions

EP-06 does not currently deliver:

- complaint handling;
- complaint escalation;
- complaint resolution;
- final administrative case closure;
- guaranteed resolution-time predictions;
- autonomous AI-generated case facts;
- autonomous AI determination of customer obligations;
- autonomous AI determination of dispute outcomes;
- removal of required human-assisted support.

These capabilities remain within later Epics or future controlled delivery horizons.

99. BA Interpretation

EP-06 demonstrates decomposition of customer communication into distinct status, action, progress, outcome and assisted-support capabilities.

The Story set avoids treating all customer communication as one generic notification feature. Instead, communication behaviour is linked to specific controlled case states and customer needs.

A particularly important distinction is maintained between current case status and customer action. A dispute may continue through internal processing without requiring the customer to do anything, and the service should communicate that accurately rather than creating unnecessary uncertainty.

Final outcome communication is also separated from decision finalisation and case closure. This creates explicit traceability between the authorised business decision, the communication event and the eventual lifecycle close.

Accessibility and human-assisted support are treated as core service-design requirements. The design does not require speculative inference of personal characteristics merely to provide support and does not allow self-service availability to eliminate an appropriate human route.

EP-06 therefore provides evidence across requirements analysis, UX analysis, stakeholder/customer needs, process design, controls and future UAT planning.

100. Conclusion

Five H1 User Stories have been created for EP-06 — Customer Status, Communication and Assisted Support.

The Stories cover current dispute status, customer-action communication, meaningful progress updates, final authorised outcome communication and human-assisted/accessibility support.

FR-039 through FR-043 now have identified backlog coverage.

Customer status, customer action, progress communication, final outcome communication and case closure remain explicitly separate lifecycle concepts.

The Story set also retains an appropriate human-supported route and treats accessibility as a core customer-service requirement.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

US-035 through US-039 are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement** rather than represented as implemented.

The next backlog stage will address complaints, escalations and closure under EP-07.

101. EP-07 — Complaints, Escalations and Closure

EP-07 establishes the controlled complaint, escalation and closure capabilities of the PayFix AI 2.0 dispute lifecycle.

The Epic allows dissatisfaction or exceptional handling requirements to remain linked to the relevant dispute while preserving the underlying case, decision, communication and operational history.

Complaints are treated as related but distinct business records rather than as replacements for the underlying dispute. Escalations similarly represent controlled handling changes rather than informal or undocumented handoffs.

The Epic also establishes the final controlled closure point of the dispute lifecycle. A dispute should only be represented as closed when the applicable lifecycle conditions have been satisfied and unresolved required actions are not being silently discarded.

EP-07 forms part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and must operate independently of AI.

Autonomous complaint outcomes, escalation decisions and case closure are excluded from the H1 design.

101.1 EP-07 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-011, BR-013, BR-014

Functional	FR-044–FR-047
User	Complaint-handling, escalation and lifecycle-completion needs from the Requirements Baseline
Data	Complaint linkage, escalation state, outcome and closure-event traceability
UX	Retain understandable case history and avoid forcing customers to repeat already available dispute context unnecessarily
Control	Complaint/dispute separation, authorised escalation, closure eligibility and audit traceability
Process	TB-12 — Complaint / Escalation and TB-13 / TB-14 — Closure and Monitoring transition
Horizon	H1 — Core Process Foundation
AI	No dependency; autonomous complaint, escalation and closure decisions excluded

Detailed requirement-to-story traceability will be added as the EP-07 User Stories are created.

Story boundaries will distinguish complaint creation and linkage, complaint/escalation handling, controlled resolution or return and final dispute closure rather than treating all post-decision activity as a single backlog item.

Complaint Separation Principle: A complaint related to the dispute must remain linked to, but distinguishable from, the underlying dispute case. Complaint handling must not silently rewrite or remove the original dispute, decision or communication history.

Closure Principle: Decision completion or customer outcome communication alone does not automatically establish case closure. Closure must reflect the applicable controlled lifecycle

state and must not hide unresolved required actions, complaints, escalations or other relevant conditions.

102. EP-07 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary User / Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
US-040	Create and Link a Complaint to the Dispute Case	Complaints / Customer Service User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-041	Investigate and Manage a Linked Complaint	Complaints User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-042	Escalate a Complaint or Dispute Through a Controlled Route	Operational / Complaints User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-043	Close the Dispute Case Through a Controlled Closure Process	Authorised Operational User	Must	H1	Backlog

103. EP-07 Requirement → Story Coverage

Functional Requirement	Story	Capability
FR-044	US-040	Create and link complaint to dispute
FR-045	US-041	Investigate and manage linked complaint
FR-046	US-042	Controlled complaint / dispute escalation
FR-047	US-043	Controlled dispute closure

Coverage Result: FR-044 through FR-047 now have identified delivery-story coverage within EP-07.

Complaint creation, complaint handling, escalation and dispute closure have deliberately been separated so that a complaint or escalation is not incorrectly treated as a closed or resolved dispute merely because its handling state has changed.

103.1 Cross-Requirement Traceability

Story	Key Requirement Trace
US-040	BR-011/013; UR-COM-001; FR-044; TB-12
US-041	BR-011/013; UR-COM-001; FR-045; TB-12
US-042	BR-011/013; UR-COM-001; UR-OPS-003; FR-046; TB-12
US-043	BR-011/014; FR-047; DR-038; CR-011/012; TB-13/14

104. EP-07 Story → To-Be Process Traceability

Story	To-Be Process
US-040	TB-12 — Create / Link Complaint
US-041	TB-12 — Complaint Handling
US-042	TB-12 — Controlled Escalation
US-043	TB-13 — Closure / TB-14 Monitoring Transition

EP-07 converts complaint, escalation and closure activities into discrete backlog capabilities while maintaining the distinction between the underlying dispute, linked complaint records, escalation states and final dispute closure.

105. EP-07 Complaint, Escalation and Closure State Model

State / Concept	Meaning
Dispute Case	Original controlled payment-dispute record
Complaint Linked	Separate complaint record associated with the dispute
Complaint Under Handling	Complaint activity is still in progress
Escalated	Additional authority, oversight or handling is required
Closure Blocking Condition	Outstanding controlled condition prevents final dispute closure
Closure Eligible	Applicable closure conditions have been satisfied
Closed	Controlled end state of the dispute lifecycle

These states remain distinct. A complaint can exist without replacing the dispute, and an escalation can occur without resolving either the complaint or underlying dispute.

Likewise, a final decision or customer outcome communication does not automatically establish closure eligibility.

106. EP-07 Story Boundary Review

US-040 vs US-041: US-040 creates and links the complaint record. US-041 performs controlled complaint investigation and management.

Complaint vs dispute: The linked complaint remains a separate business record and does not overwrite the underlying payment-dispute lifecycle.

US-041 vs dispute-decision amendment: Complaint findings may identify a need to reconsider the dispute decision, but any material decision change must use the controlled decision amendment or override process defined under US-033.

US-041 vs US-042: Complaint handling may remain within the standard complaints route. US-042 is used where additional authority, oversight or controlled escalation is required.

US-042 vs resolution: Escalation represents a controlled change in handling. It does not by itself establish resolution.

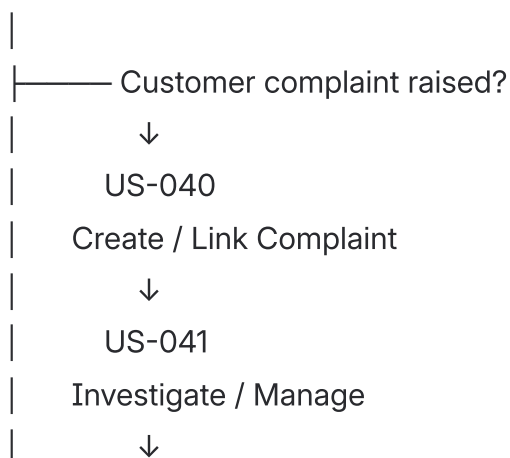
US-043 vs decision completion: A completed dispute decision is one lifecycle input but does not automatically close the case.

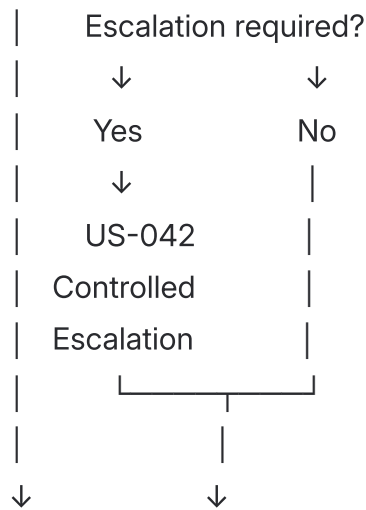
US-043 vs customer communication: Communication of the final authorised outcome does not by itself close the dispute.

US-043 vs unresolved complaint or escalation: Where an unresolved complaint or escalation legitimately prevents closure, the condition remains visible rather than being discarded merely to close the dispute.

107. EP-07 Logical Story Dependencies

Controlled Dispute Lifecycle





Applicable lifecycle conditions resolved



US-043

Controlled Case Closure



TB-14 Monitoring /

Improvement Data

This represents **logical capability relationships only**. It is not a committed Sprint sequence or detailed technical workflow.

Complaint and escalation activity may occur at different points in the dispute lifecycle, and a case may require additional controlled processing before it becomes eligible for closure.

108. EP-07 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-040	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-041	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-042	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-043	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The Stories have genuine lifecycle dependencies but remain independently understandable and testable business capabilities. INVEST independence is therefore applied pragmatically to complaint, escalation and closure outcomes.

109. EP-07 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Story	Acceptance Focus
Complaint creation	US-040	Linkage, record separation, context and traceability
Complaint handling	US-041	Investigation, findings, accountability and decision boundaries
Escalation	US-042	Reason, destination, authority, ownership and traceability
Closure	US-043	Eligibility, blockers, history, accountability and lifecycle completion

Acceptance criteria define observable business and control behaviour without prescribing a specific complaints platform, workflow implementation, archival technology or organisational structure.

Detailed complaint, escalation, closure, negative-path and audit UAT scenarios will be developed later within the Testing and UAT workstream.

110. EP-07 Explicit Exclusions

EP-07 does not currently deliver:

- autonomous complaint resolution;
- autonomous escalation decisions;
- autonomous dispute closure;
- AI-generated final authority;
- physical archival implementation;
- retention-period configuration;
- physical data deletion;

- workforce optimisation;
- performance-dashboard implementation.

These items remain outside H1 Story scope or belong to later delivery and technical design work.

111. BA Interpretation

EP-07 demonstrates controlled modelling of complaint, escalation and closure capabilities while preserving the integrity of the underlying dispute lifecycle.

A linked complaint is represented as a separate business record rather than being treated as a replacement for the dispute. This maintains traceability between the customer's complaint and the original intake, investigation, specialist, decision and communication history.

Escalation is similarly modelled as a controlled handling state rather than an informal transfer. Escalation reason, destination, accountability and previous case history remain identifiable.

The closure Story establishes an important lifecycle control: completion of investigation, decision-making or customer communication does not independently constitute case closure. Applicable unresolved conditions remain visible and may prevent closure where required.

This Story set therefore provides evidence of business modelling, process analysis, requirements decomposition, exception handling, data-state analysis, controls and future UAT design.

112. Conclusion

Four H1 User Stories have been created for EP-07 — Complaints, Escalations and Closure.

The Stories cover creation and linkage of dispute-related complaints, controlled complaint handling, controlled escalation and final dispute closure.

FR-044 through FR-047 now have identified backlog coverage.

The Story set preserves clear distinctions between the underlying dispute, linked complaint, escalation state, dispute decision, customer communication and final closure.

Closure eligibility explicitly considers applicable unresolved actions and controlled conditions rather than treating one earlier lifecycle event as sufficient evidence of closure.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

US-040 through US-043 are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement** rather than represented as implemented.

113. Step 25E — Decisions, Communication, Complaints and Closure Conclusion

Step 25E has converted the decision, communication, complaint, escalation and closure requirements into delivery-ready Agile backlog Stories across three Epics:

EP-05 — Decision and Approval Controls: US-030–US-034

EP-06 — Customer Status, Communication and Assisted Support: US-035–US-039

EP-07 — Complaints, Escalations and Closure: US-040–US-043

A total of **14 User Stories** were defined within Step 25E.

The design maintains explicit separation between decision review, decision recording, approval, decision finalisation, customer communication, complaint handling, escalation and case closure.

Human authority remains explicit for sensitive customer-impacting decisions, and the H1 lifecycle does not depend on AI.

Across EP-01 through EP-07, the portfolio now contains **43 User Stories (US-001–US-043)** covering the core H1 dispute lifecycle from initiation through controlled closure.

These Stories are classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement**, not implemented or tested.

The overall Jira analysis task **Create user stories and acceptance criteria** remains **In Analysis** because Step 25 will continue with cross-cutting data, controls, NFRs, automation and responsible-AI backlog work.

114. EP-08 — Process Data, Audit and Reporting

EP-08 establishes the cross-cutting process-data, lifecycle-event, audit and reporting foundation for PayFix AI 2.0.

Unlike EP-01 through EP-07, this Epic is not one sequential stage of the dispute journey. It supports the entire lifecycle by ensuring that material events, state changes, accountable actions and reporting measures can be traced consistently.

The Epic provides the backlog foundation for process-event information, auditability, source-of-truth controls, data-quality handling, KPI-ready information and operational reporting.

The design does not assume that every field must be visible to every user. Audit and reporting access remains subject to applicable security, privacy and role controls.

EP-08 forms part of **H1 — Core Process Foundation** and operates independently of AI.

Future automation and AI capabilities must build on this controlled data foundation rather than replacing authoritative lifecycle or audit records.

114.1 EP-08 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-011, BR-017
Functional	Cross-cutting lifecycle monitoring/reporting capability where applicable
Data	Lifecycle events, identifiers, state changes, audit information, measurement, source-of-truth and data-quality requirements
Control	Actor/action traceability, reason/override traceability, controlled data access and audit integrity
NFR	Security, privacy, reliability, auditability, maintainability, integration and operational measurement requirements
Process	Cross-lifecycle EP-01–EP-07; supports TB-14 Monitoring / Improvement
Horizon	H1 — Core Process Foundation
AI	No dependency; AI-specific monitoring remains outside this Epic

Detailed DR, CR and NFR allocation will be added at Story level during Step 25F.

Cross-cutting requirements will be grouped into coherent delivery outcomes rather than creating one Story for every individual Data, Control or Non-Functional Requirement.

Cross-Cutting Requirements Principle: A requirement that applies to several lifecycle stages should not be copied into multiple duplicate Stories unless different user or system behaviour genuinely requires separate implementation outcomes. Instead, EP-08 provides shared capabilities that can be referenced by the relevant lifecycle Stories and later testing evidence.

Authoritative Data Principle: Reporting, audit and future automation must rely on controlled source information and defined transformation or calculation logic. Missing or uncertain information must remain distinguishable from known values rather than being silently fabricated.

Audit Principle: Auditability requires sufficient traceability of material actions and state changes, but it does not require unrestricted access to all underlying information. Access remains governed by applicable security, privacy and role controls.

115. EP-08 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
US-044	Record Material Lifecycle Events and Maintain an Audit Trail	Operational / Assurance / Service User	Must	H1	Backlog

US-045	Maintain Reliable Case and Record Relationships	Operational / Service / Assurance User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-046	Maintain Defined and Authoritative Case Data	Operational / Service / Assurance User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-047	Produce Consistent Operational and Performance Measures	Operational / Service / Process Management	Must	H1	Backlog
US-048	Provide Authorised Operational Reporting and Monitoring	Operational / Service / Process Management	Must	H1	Backlog
US-049	Detect and Handle Data-Quality Exceptions	Operational / Service / Assurance User	Must	H1	Backlog

116. EP-08 Cross-Cutting Capability Coverage

Capability	Story	Primary Purpose
Lifecycle Events & Audit	US-044	Trace material actions, events and state changes
Record Relationships	US-045	Preserve correct links between controlled business records
Authoritative Data	US-046	Establish defined meanings and trustworthy source information
KPI / Measurement	US-047	Define reproducible operational measures
Reporting / Monitoring	US-048	Provide authorised operational visibility
Data-Quality Exceptions	US-049	Detect and control missing, invalid or inconsistent data

Coverage Result: EP-08 decomposes the shared process-data, audit, measurement, reporting and data-quality foundation into six coherent cross-cutting Stories rather than duplicating the same requirements across every lifecycle Epic.

These Stories support EP-01 through EP-07 and the TB-14 Monitoring / Improvement capability.

116.1 Requirements Allocation Status

The approved Step 24 Requirements Baseline contains the authoritative Data, Control and Non-Functional Requirement IDs.

At Story creation stage, exact DR, CR and NFR IDs were deliberately not guessed where the individual baseline definition was not available for direct validation.

EP-08 therefore currently maintains capability-level traceability to the following requirement families:

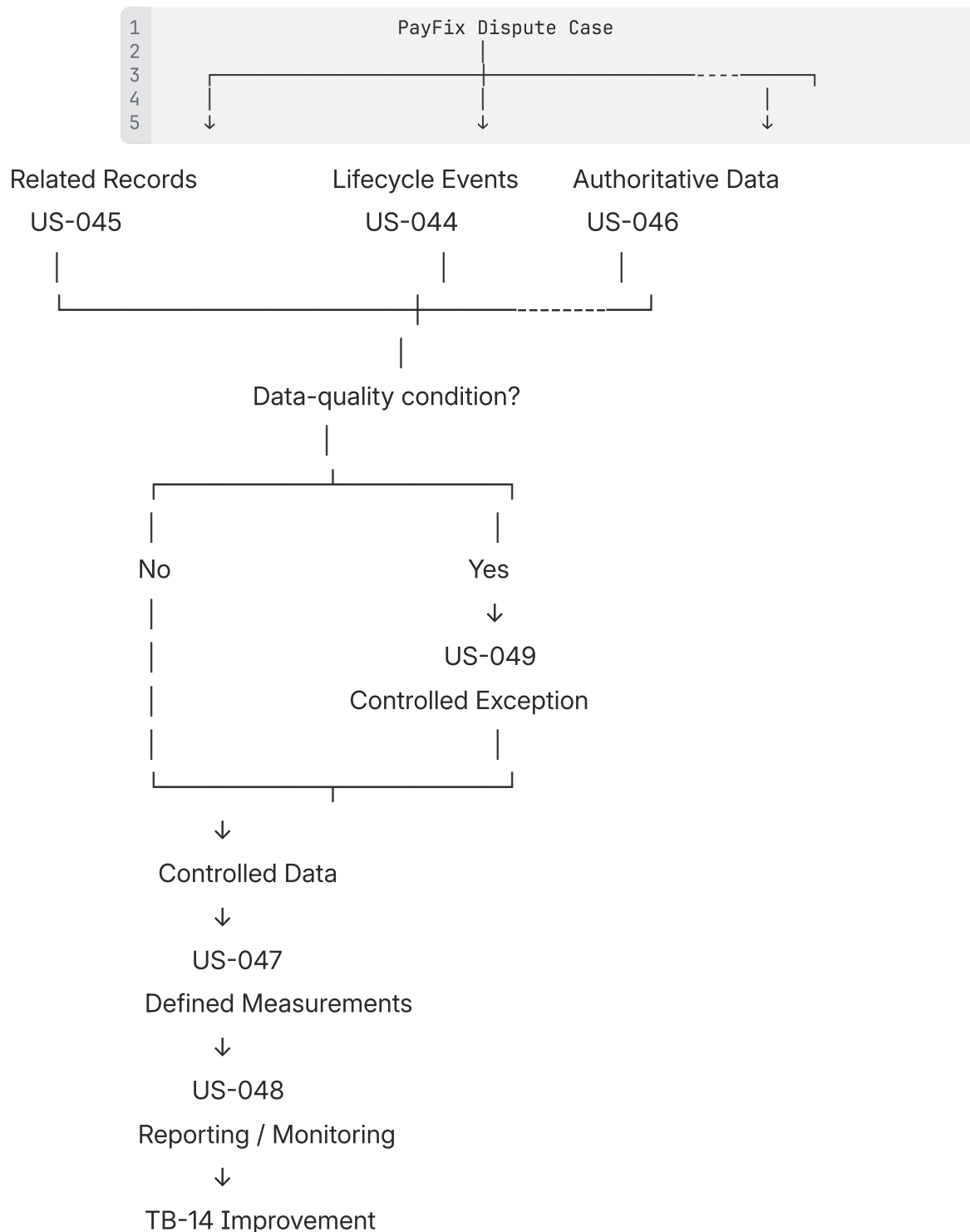
- DR — identity, relationships, lifecycle events, source-of-truth, measurement and data quality;

- CR — auditability, controlled action, correction, override and access;
- NFR — security, privacy, reliability, performance, maintainability, integration and capacity.

Exact requirement IDs will only be inserted after checking them against the authoritative Step 24 Requirements Baseline.

This prevents false traceability and preserves the integrity of the portfolio requirements chain.

117. EP-08 Cross-Cutting Data and Information Model



118. EP-08 Story Boundary Review

US-044 vs US-045: US-044 records what materially happened. US-045 establishes which business records are correctly related.

US-045 vs US-046: US-045 governs relationship integrity. US-046 governs the meaning, validity and authoritative use of the underlying data.

US-046 vs US-049: US-046 establishes what valid and authoritative data should look like. US-049 defines controlled behaviour when that expectation is not satisfied.

US-047 vs US-048: US-047 defines and calculates operational measures. US-048 exposes approved measures through authorised reporting and monitoring.

US-047 vs business targets: A calculated baseline measure is not automatically an approved future target.

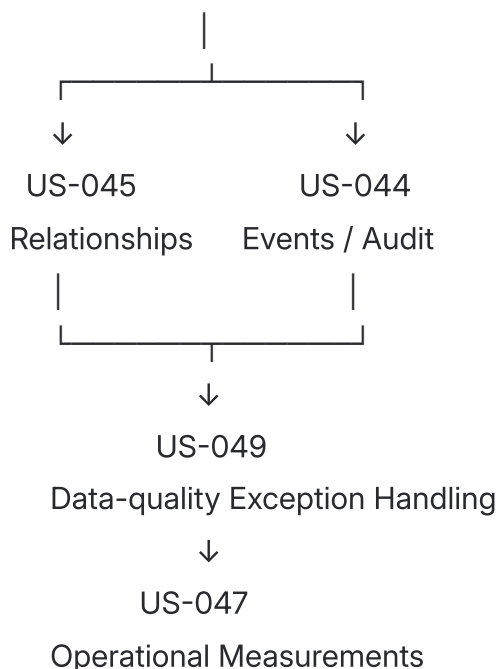
US-048 vs source of truth: A dashboard or reporting view consumes controlled information but does not become an alternative authoritative case record merely because it displays that information.

US-049 vs business exception: A data-quality problem is distinguishable from a legitimate business state or authorised business-rule exception.

Data correction vs override: Correcting incorrect data is not the same as intentionally overriding a valid business rule through an authorised exception route.

119. EP-08 Logical Story Dependencies

US-046 Defined / Authoritative Data





TB-14 Monitoring / Improvement

The relationships are logical capability dependencies rather than a committed Sprint sequence. Cross-cutting Stories may be implemented incrementally alongside the lifecycle capabilities they support.

120. EP-08 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-044	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-045	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-046	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-047	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-048	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-049	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

EP-08 Stories intentionally have shared data dependencies because they represent cross-cutting service capabilities. They remain sufficiently bounded to provide distinct business value and independently testable acceptance behaviour.

121. EP-08 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Story	Acceptance Focus
Audit / events	US-044	Actor, time, state, reason, history and traceability

Relationships	US-045	Correct record linkage and independent business identities
Authoritative data	US-046	Definitions, sources, validity and uncertainty
Measurement	US-047	Population, denominator, calculation and reproducibility
Reporting	US-048	Authorised visibility, consistency and source separation
Data quality	US-049	Missing/invalid/inconsistent data and controlled exception handling

Detailed test scenarios will later include positive, negative, exception and boundary cases across audit, relationship integrity, data quality, measurement and reporting.

EP-08 defines business and acceptance behaviour without prescribing the physical database, reporting platform, event-stream technology or production architecture.

122. EP-08 Explicit Exclusions

EP-08 does not currently select or implement:

- physical database architecture;
- database schema or indexing;
- Kafka or another event-stream technology;
- immutable ledger or blockchain;
- SIEM tooling;

- ETL/data-remediation tooling;
- Power BI or Tableau production implementation;
- production data warehouse;
- predictive analytics;
- automatic root-cause determination;
- AI model monitoring;
- autonomous AI data correction;
- approved future KPI targets.

These remain technical-design, later-delivery or separate governance concerns.

123. BA Interpretation

EP-08 demonstrates decomposition of cross-cutting digital and data requirements into delivery-ready business capabilities.

The Story set distinguishes current case state from historical events, business-record identity from record relationships, source information from derived measures, baseline performance from future targets and reporting views from authoritative case data.

It also establishes explicit treatment of missing, invalid, inconsistent and uncertain information rather than silently forcing incomplete data into apparently valid outcomes.

This is particularly important for PayFix AI 2.0 because later workflow automation and AI capabilities will depend on the integrity of the underlying case and event information.

The Epic therefore creates a controlled data foundation before those later capabilities are introduced.

The analysis provides portfolio evidence across digital and data systems analysis, business modelling, requirements management, process improvement, controls and future testing/UAT design.

124. Conclusion

Six H1 User Stories have been defined for EP-08 — Process Data, Audit and Reporting.

The Stories cover lifecycle-event traceability, business-record relationships, authoritative case data, operational measurement, authorised reporting and data-quality exception handling.

EP-08 operates as a cross-cutting foundation supporting EP-01 through EP-07 and TB-14 Monitoring / Improvement.

Exact DR, CR and NFR IDs have not been fabricated where the authoritative Step 24 requirement definition has not been directly validated. Capability-level traceability has been retained until the baseline can be checked.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and has been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

US-044 through US-049 are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement**, not implemented or tested.

125. EP-09 — Rules, Controls and Service Resilience

EP-09 establishes the deterministic rules, authority controls, exception behaviour and service-resilience foundation required across PayFix AI 2.0.

Unlike a single customer-journey stage, the Epic supports multiple lifecycle capabilities including completeness assessment, classification, routing, ownership, investigation, specialist handling, decisions, approvals, complaints, escalation and closure.

The Epic deliberately separates a **business rule** from an **automated implementation of that rule**. PayFix AI 2.0 should first establish what the approved rule is, what data it requires, what happens when the rule cannot be applied, what authority boundaries exist and how exceptions are controlled.

Selective deterministic automation will be considered later during Step 25G only after this control foundation is established.

The design also establishes safe behaviour for technical or integration failure. A failed technical action must not silently become a successful business state.

EP-09 therefore supports the H1 core foundation while also providing the prerequisite controls for later H2 automation.

125.1 EP-09 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	BR-003, BR-007, BR-011, BR-012, BR-015, BR-016
Functional	Rule-driven and exception/fallback behaviour across applicable lifecycle functions
Data	Controlled inputs, rule results, exception context and action/state traceability
Control	Human authority, approval, exception, override, fallback and controlled-action requirements
NFR	Reliability, resilience, security, maintainability, integration, recovery and capacity
Process	Cross-lifecycle EP-01–EP-07
Current Horizon	Primarily H1 — Core Process Foundation
Later Extension	H2 — Selective Automation during Step 25G
AI	No dependency for Step 25F

Exact CR and NFR allocation will be completed only against the authoritative Step 24 Requirements Baseline. Requirement numbers will not be guessed where the baseline wording has not been directly validated.

EP-09 Stories will first define deterministic rule, authority, exception and resilience behaviour. Automation Stories will be added separately during Step 25G.

Rule vs Automation Principle: A business rule defines the approved decision or processing logic. Automation defines whether and how technology executes that rule without a manual step. A rule may therefore exist and operate before it is automated.

Example:

Rule: An ambiguous classification requires authorised review.

Automation: The system automatically detects the ambiguity and routes the case to the appropriate review queue.

The rule is the business requirement. The automated routing is a later implementation capability.

Authority Principle: Deterministic rules, workflow technology and automated processing do not grant additional business authority. Where a decision, approval, override, complaint outcome or closure exception requires an authorised human role, that authority boundary remains applicable regardless of how much surrounding workflow is automated.

Failure-State Principle: Technical success and business success are separate concepts. If a service, integration or workflow action fails, PayFix AI 2.0 must not silently represent the intended business action as completed.

For example:

- routing requested does not necessarily mean routing completed;
- notification generated does not necessarily mean notification delivered;
- refund instruction prepared does not necessarily mean refund executed;
- closure attempted does not necessarily mean case closed.

Exception Principle: A normal rule result, authorised business exception, data correction, system failure and unauthorised bypass are different states and should remain distinguishable where material.

Approved exceptions and overrides should retain sufficient reason, authority and traceability to support later operational review and testing.

126. EP-09 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Primary Role	Priority	Horizon	Status
US-050	Apply Defined Deterministic Business Rules	Operational / Service User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-051	Apply Controlled Exceptions and Overrides	Operational / Control User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-052	Enforce Authorised Actions and Approval Boundaries	Operational / Control User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-053	Handle Service and Integration Failures Safely	Operational / Service User	Must	H1	Backlog

US-054	Recover and Continue Through an Approved Fallback Route	Operational / Service User	Must	H1	Backlog
US-055	Maintain Reliable Case Processing and Recover from Interruptions	Operational / Service User	Must	H1	Backlog

127. EP-09 Rules, Controls and Resilience Coverage

Capability	Story	Primary Purpose
Deterministic Rules	US-050	Apply approved predictable business logic
Exceptions / Overrides	US-051	Control permitted departures from standard rules
Authority / Approval	US-052	Restrict sensitive actions to authorised roles/functions
Failure Handling	US-053	Prevent technical failures becoming false business success

Fallback / Recovery Route	US-054	Use approved alternative processing where appropriate
Case Reliability / Resume	US-055	Preserve and recover the correct lifecycle state

Coverage Result: EP-09's Step 25F tranche decomposes deterministic rule behaviour, controlled exceptions, authority boundaries, technical failure handling, approved fallback and case recovery into six separate cross-cutting Stories.

The design intentionally avoids combining business rules, automation, technical failure and human authority into one oversized Story.

127.1 Requirements Allocation Status

EP-09 is supported by the approved Step 24 Functional, Control and Non-Functional Requirement baselines.

The relevant requirement families include rule-driven processing, exceptions, fallback, recovery, authority, approvals, auditability, reliability, resilience, security, maintainability and integration.

The FR-048–FR-052 requirement family contains the remaining exception, fallback and monitoring-related functional requirements, but exact Story-level allocation will only be inserted after validating each authoritative baseline definition.

Exact CR and NFR IDs are likewise not being guessed where their Step 24 wording is not directly available for validation.

This preserves requirements-traceability integrity rather than manufacturing apparently precise but unsupported mappings.

128. EP-09 Rules, Controls and Resilience State Model

Concept	Meaning
Deterministic Rule	Approved predictable business logic

Normal Rule Result	Outcome created through standard rule behaviour
Authorised Exception	Permitted departure from normal rule behaviour
Override	Controlled alteration requiring applicable authority
Unauthorised Bypass	Rule/control avoided without valid authority
Data Correction	Incorrect data changed to the valid value
Technical Failure	Required technical action failed or remains unconfirmed
Fallback	Approved alternative route when normal route is unavailable
Recovery	Return to a valid processable state after disruption
Reconciliation	Establish what actually occurred where prior outcome is uncertain
Approval	Separate controlled authorisation where required

These concepts are intentionally separate. A technical failure is not a business exception, a data correction is not an override, and a fallback route does not remove mandatory authority or approval controls.

129. EP-09 Story Boundary Review

US-050 vs automation: US-050 defines deterministic business behaviour. It does not determine whether technology automatically executes that behaviour.

US-050 vs US-051: US-050 covers the normal approved rule path. US-051 covers a permitted controlled departure from that path.

US-051 vs data correction: Correcting inaccurate information restores valid data. It does not automatically represent an override of a valid rule.

US-051 vs unauthorised bypass: A controlled exception requires an approved route and applicable authority. Informally skipping a rule is not a valid exception.

US-052 vs operational access: Being able to view, own or investigate a case does not automatically establish decision, approval or override authority.

US-052 vs automation: Technology executing a workflow does not acquire independent business authority.

US-053 vs US-054: US-053 establishes that an action failed, remains unconfirmed or cannot safely complete. US-054 defines the approved alternative route where one exists.

US-054 vs US-051: A fallback maintains the legitimate business purpose through an approved alternative route. An override deliberately departs from standard business-rule behaviour.

US-054 vs retry: A retry repeats an action. A fallback may use a different approved route. Retrying may be unsafe where the original outcome is uncertain.

US-055 vs US-053: US-053 handles the failure event; US-055 preserves and correctly resumes the wider case lifecycle through the interruption.

US-055 vs infrastructure disaster recovery: US-055 specifies business-state reliability and recovery behaviour, not cloud, backup or infrastructure architecture.

130. EP-09 Logical Story Dependencies

Controlled / Authoritative Case Data



US-050

Deterministic Business Rule



Authority required?



US-052

Authority / Approval



Normal path possible?



Yes



No



Continue Is business exception needed?



US-051



Technical action



Completed safely?



Yes



No / Unknown



Continue



US-053 Failure Handling



Approved fallback?



Yes



No



US-054



Hold /

Fallback /

Escalate /

Recovery

Recover



US-055

Preserve / Resume Case



Controlled Lifecycle

This represents logical dependency relationships only. It is not a committed technical workflow or Sprint sequence.

Selective automation is intentionally excluded from this Step 25F model and will be added during Step 25G.

131. EP-09 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
-------	-------------	----------	-------	----------	--------

US-050	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-051	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-052	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-053	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-054	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-055	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

EP-09 Stories deliberately share control and data dependencies but represent distinct business outcomes. Their acceptance criteria allow rule, authority, exception, failure, fallback and recovery behaviour to be tested independently.

132. EP-09 Acceptance Coverage

Capability	Story	Acceptance Focus
Deterministic rules	US-050	Inputs, rule result, consistency, missing/ambiguous conditions
Exceptions / overrides	US-051	Authority, reason, traceability and historical integrity
Authority / approval	US-052	Restricted actions, approval boundaries and separation where required
Failure handling	US-053	Failure visibility, state integrity, safe retry and no false completion
Fallback	US-054	Approved alternatives, control preservation, reconciliation

Reliability / recovery	US-055	State preservation, correct resume point and duplicate prevention
------------------------	--------	--

Detailed testing later will include positive, negative, boundary, unauthorised-action, failed-service, uncertain-outcome, retry, fallback and recovery scenarios.

EP-09 defines business and control behaviour rather than prescribing a workflow engine, identity platform, retry technology, infrastructure architecture or automated implementation.

133. EP-09 Step 25F Explicit Exclusions

The Step 25F tranche of EP-09 does not implement:

- selective workflow automation;
- autonomous workflow decisions;
- AI agents;
- AI classification;
- AI recommendations as authority;
- workflow-engine technology;
- IAM/RBAC platform configuration;
- production approval matrices;
- API gateway architecture;
- message-broker technology;
- disaster-recovery infrastructure;
- infrastructure RTO/RPO targets;
- production monitoring tooling;
- automatically generated fallback routes.

134. BA Interpretation

EP-09 demonstrates decomposition of cross-cutting rules, controls and resilience into explicit and testable backlog capabilities.

The analysis distinguishes business rules from their technical automation, normal rule results from authorised exceptions, access from business authority, technical failure from business outcomes, fallback from override and recovery from restarting an entire process.

This prevents a common transformation-design problem in which workflow technology is treated as though it defines business policy or authority.

The design also establishes that uncertain technical outcomes must be reconciled before potentially duplicated customer-impacting actions are repeated.

Human authority remains explicit for sensitive decisions, approvals and permitted overrides.

These capabilities establish the control and resilience foundation required before selective automation is introduced during Step 25G.

135. EP-09 Step 25F Tranche Conclusion

Six H1 cross-cutting User Stories have been defined for the Step 25F tranche of EP-09 — Rules, Controls and Service Resilience.

The Stories cover deterministic business rules, controlled exceptions and overrides, authority and approval boundaries, safe technical-failure handling, approved fallback routes and reliable recovery of case processing.

US-050 through US-055 have defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria and have been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready.

They are therefore classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement**, not implemented or tested.

EP-09 itself remains open because Step 25G will extend the Epic with selective deterministic automation capabilities built on this control foundation.

136. Step 25F — Data, Controls and NFR Cross-Cutting Backlog Conclusion

Step 25F has converted PayFix AI 2.0's major cross-cutting data, control and service-quality requirements into two structured backlog areas:

EP-08 — Process Data, Audit and Reporting: US-044–US-049

EP-09 — Rules, Controls and Service Resilience, Step 25F tranche: US-050–US-055

Step 25F therefore contains **12 cross-cutting User Stories**.

EP-08 establishes lifecycle-event traceability, record relationships, authoritative data, operational measurement, reporting and data-quality exception handling.

EP-09 establishes deterministic rules, exceptions and overrides, authority boundaries, safe failure behaviour, controlled fallback and reliable case recovery.

Together these capabilities provide the controlled data and operational foundation required before selective automation or AI is introduced.

Across EP-01 through EP-09, the portfolio now contains **55 User Stories (US-001-US-055)**.

These Stories are backlog-analysis outputs classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement** and are not represented as implemented, tested or accepted.

The main Jira analysis item **Create user stories and acceptance criteria** remains **In Analysis** because Step 25G and Step 25H are still outstanding.

137. Step 25G — Selective Deterministic Automation

Step 25G defines a deliberately limited set of H2 deterministic automation capabilities for PayFix AI 2.0.

Automation is introduced only after the H1 rule, authority, exception, failure, fallback, recovery, audit and data-quality foundations have been defined.

The objective is to reduce repetitive operational effort without automating sensitive business authority or making the H1 dispute process dependent on automation.

Step 25G therefore follows the principle:

Automate execution where rules are deterministic; retain human judgement and authority where the business requires them.

AI is not required for any Step 25G capability.

138. Step 25G Selective Automation Story Catalogue

Story ID	Jira Title	Priority	Horizon	AI Dependen cy	Status
US-056	Automate Eligible Determinis tic Workflow Actions	Should	H2	None	Backlog

US-057	Automate Rule-Based Routing and Assignment	Should	H2	None	Backlog
US-058	Automate Customer Action and Follow-Up Workflow	Should	H2	None	Backlog
US-059	Automate Operational Alerts and Escalation Triggers	Should	H2	None	Backlog
US-060	Automate Controlled Operational Notifications and Status Updates	Should	H2	None	Backlog

139. Step 25G Automation Capability Coverage

Automation Area	Story	What is Automated
Cross-cutting workflow	US-056	Eligible deterministic workflow execution
Routing / Assignment	US-057	Clear rule-based route and ownership actions

Customer Action	US-058	Defined requests, waiting states and follow-up
Operational Attention	US-059	Alerts and escalation triggers
Notifications / Status	US-060	Communication of confirmed events and states

Coverage Result: Step 25G intentionally automates a limited number of repetitive, deterministic processing activities rather than attempting to automate the entire dispute lifecycle.

Sensitive decisions, fraud judgement, approvals, material overrides and other activities requiring designated human authority remain outside autonomous execution.

140. Automation Suitability Assessment

Suitability Question	Required Answer
Is the underlying business rule defined?	Yes
Is the rule deterministic?	Yes
Are required inputs sufficiently controlled?	Yes
Is the resulting action unambiguous?	Yes
Can the action be traced?	Yes
Can failure be detected?	Yes
Is safe fallback/recovery available where required?	Yes / appropriately handled
Does the action require independent human judgement?	No

Does the action require restricted business authority?	No
Can H1 continue if automation is unavailable?	Yes

A failure against the authority or judgement criteria prevents autonomous execution even where the surrounding workflow could technically be automated.

Technical feasibility alone is therefore not sufficient evidence of automation suitability.

140.1 Activities Not Selected for Autonomous Execution

Activity	Reason
Sensitive dispute decision	Requires controlled business authority
Fraud determination	Requires specialist/human judgement
Required approval	Automation cannot approve its own outcome
Material override	Requires authorised exception route
Ambiguous classification	Deterministic result unavailable
Unsupported evidence sufficiency judgement	May require human assessment
Complaint outcome	Distinct controlled handling
Unsupported closure decision	Closure controls must remain satisfied
Creation of missing facts	Automation cannot fabricate case information

141. Rule, Automation and AI Separation

Layer	Purpose	Example
-------	---------	---------

Business Rule	Defines approved logic	Unauthorised Transaction routes to Fraud Review
H1 Process	Allows rule to be applied without automation	User/system applies routing rule
H2 Automation	Executes eligible rule automatically	Automatically routes clear match
H3 AI	Optional assisted capability	Summarises evidence for human review
Human Authority	Makes controlled decisions where required	Authorised fraud/refund decision

ayFix AI 2.0 does not treat deterministic automation and AI as interchangeable concepts.

Automation executes explicitly defined logic.

AI may later provide probabilistic or generative assistance within approved boundaries.

Human authority remains separate from both.

142. Step 25G Story Boundary Review

US-056 vs US-050: US-050 defines deterministic business rules. US-056 permits eligible rules to have selected workflow execution automated.

US-056 vs US-057: US-056 establishes the general selective-automation capability and controls. US-057 applies that approach specifically to routing and assignment.

US-057 vs AI routing: US-057 uses deterministic controlled rules. It does not perform probabilistic AI routing.

US-058 vs US-060: US-058 manages outstanding customer action and follow-up. US-060 communicates confirmed lifecycle facts and states.

US-059 vs US-042: US-059 may identify and alert on an approved escalation condition. US-042 remains the controlled escalation capability.

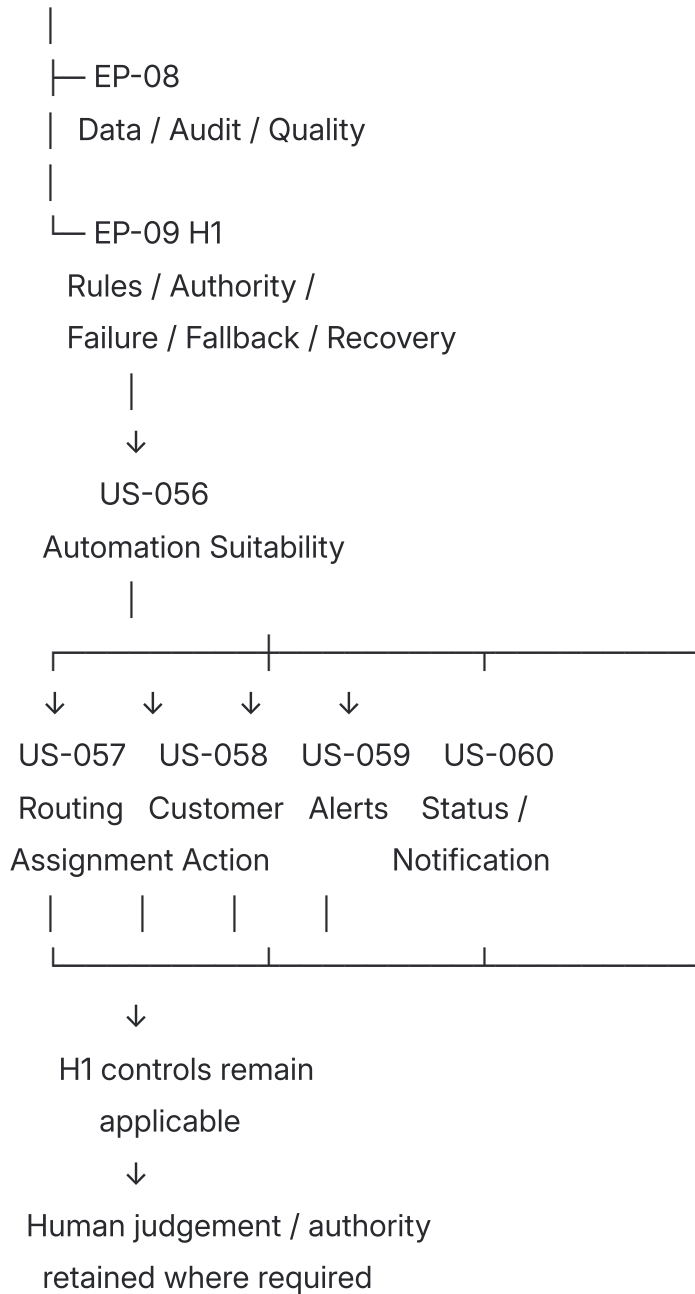
US-059 alert vs decision: An alert identifies required attention; it does not establish the resulting business decision.

US-060 communication vs case state: A notification communicates an established case fact; it does not create the fact.

H2 vs H1: All selected H2 capabilities enhance an existing H1 process. They do not replace the H1 non-automated route.

143. Step 25G Logical Automation Dependencies

H1 Controlled Foundation



This is a logical BA dependency model and does not prescribe a workflow platform or technical orchestration architecture.

144. Step 25G INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-056	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-057	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-058	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-059	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-060	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The automation Stories share H1 control dependencies by design. Each nevertheless represents a bounded automation outcome that can be tested independently against deterministic business rules, failure behaviour and human-control boundaries.

145. H1 Core Independence from H2 Automation

PayFix AI 2.0's H1 core remains capable of operating without the H2 selective-automation capabilities.

If US-056–US-060 are disabled, unavailable or not delivered, the underlying H1 rules and manually supported workflows remain valid.

This reduces dependency risk and prevents optional automation from becoming a hidden prerequisite for the core dispute service.

The H2 automation therefore provides efficiency and consistency benefits rather than creating the fundamental business capability.

146. Step 25G Explicit Exclusions

Step 25G does not automate:

- final sensitive dispute decisions;
- fraud decisions;
- independent approvals;
- unauthorised overrides;
- complaint outcomes;
- unsupported case closure;

- ambiguous classification requiring judgement;
- evidence sufficiency requiring judgement;
- creation of missing case information;
- predictive AI routing;
- AI-generated mandatory rules;
- AI agents.

AI-specific functionality remains in Step 25H.

147. BA Interpretation

Step 25G demonstrates selective automation analysis rather than automation for its own sake.

Candidate activities were assessed against rule determinism, input quality, ambiguity, authority requirements, exception behaviour, failure handling and H1 fallback capability.

The resulting backlog focuses on repetitive operational execution: routing and assignment, customer follow-up, operational alerts and controlled notifications.

High-risk or judgement-dependent activities remain human-controlled.

This establishes a clear boundary between business rules, deterministic workflow automation, future AI assistance and human business authority.

148. Selective Automation Conclusion

Five H2 selective-automation User Stories have been defined for PayFix AI 2.0: US-056 through US-060.

These Stories automate only approved deterministic workflow activities built on the H1 data, audit, rule, authority, failure, fallback and recovery foundation.

Each Story has defined Given/When/Then acceptance criteria, explicit human-control boundaries, failure behaviour and a non-automated H1 route.

US-056 through US-060 have been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready and are classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement**, not implemented or tested.

EP-09 backlog analysis is now complete across both H1 and H2.

The portfolio now contains **60 User Stories — US-001 through US-060**.

Step 25H will define only the selected controlled AI pilots and then complete the overall Product Backlog analysis.

149. EP-10 — AI Pilot: Evidence Summarisation

EP-10 defines the first controlled H3 AI pilot for PayFix AI 2.0.

The pilot focuses on AI-assisted summarisation of dispute evidence to support authorised operational users during investigation and specialist review.

Evidence summarisation was selected because it offers potential efficiency and usability value without requiring AI to become the final business decision-maker.

The capability follows an assistive model:

Controlled Evidence → AI Draft Summary → Human Review → Continued Human-Controlled Processing

The underlying evidence remains authoritative. The AI-generated summary is a derived artefact and must not replace, overwrite or silently alter its source information.

AI output does not constitute a fraud determination, refund decision, approval, specialist finding or final dispute outcome.

The H1/H2 service remains capable of operating without this AI capability.

149.1 EP-10 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	Investigation support, traceability and AI-independent core service
Functional	Existing evidence/investigation capabilities remain authoritative
Data	Controlled evidence input, source relationship and derived-summary separation
Control	Human review, authority boundaries, correction/rejection and traceability

NFR	Reliability, privacy, security, auditability and usability
AI Requirements	Grounding, human review, authority limitation, traceability and evaluation
Process	Investigation / Evidence and Specialist Review
Horizon	H3 — Controlled AI Pilot
Core Dependency	H1/H2 service operates without AI

Exact AIR, DR, CR and NFR Story-level IDs will only be allocated against the authoritative Step 24 Requirements Baseline.

The portfolio will not create false precision by guessing individual requirement numbers.

Evidence Boundary

PayFix AI 2.0 distinguishes:

Source Evidence ≠ AI Summary ≠ Human Investigation Finding ≠ Specialist Finding ≠ Final Decision

The AI pilot operates only at the summary-assistance layer.

A concise or confident AI summary must not be treated as proof that the source evidence establishes a particular decision outcome.

Grounding Principle

AI summaries should be based on the controlled information provided for the applicable case.

Missing, contradictory or uncertain source information should remain recognisable as such.

The capability must not manufacture evidence, create unsupported facts or convert ambiguity into certainty merely to produce a complete-looking summary.

Human Review Principle

An authorised user remains responsible for reviewing the AI-assisted summary where it is used to support controlled operational activity.

The reviewer must remain able to refer back to relevant source evidence, correct or reject misleading output and continue through the non-AI process where the AI output is unusable.

Pilot Evaluation Principle

Wider use will not be assumed merely because the capability can technically generate a summary.

The controlled pilot will later be assessed against explicit evidence such as grounding quality, factual consistency, omission/error patterns, human-review behaviour, usability, operational value and safe failure behaviour.

No production adoption decision has yet been made.

150. EP-10 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Story	Horizon	Priority	AI Role	Status
US-061	Generate a Grounded Draft Evidence Summary	H3	Should	Generate draft	Backlog
US-062	Review, Correct or Reject an AI-Generated Evidence Summary	H3	Should	Human-control layer	Backlog

US-063	Evaluate the Evidence Summaris ation AI Pilot	H3	Should	Pilot evaluation	Backlog
--------	--	----	--------	---------------------	---------

151. EP-10 AI Control Chain

Authoritative Source Evidence



US-061

AI Draft Summary



US-062

Human Review



Accept Correct Reject Disregard



Human-controlled investigation /
specialist review continues



US-063

Controlled Pilot Evaluation



Evidence-based recommendation



Continue / Modify / Restrict /
Evaluate Further / Stop

The AI summary remains a derived assistance artefact throughout this lifecycle. Source evidence remains authoritative, and neither AI generation nor human acceptance of a summary automatically establishes an investigation finding, specialist finding or final dispute decision.

152. EP-10 Evidence and Authority Boundaries

Artefact / Activity	Authority
Source evidence	Authoritative evidence record
AI-generated summary	Derived draft assistance
Human-reviewed summary	Reviewed assistance artefact
Investigation finding	Human-controlled operational finding
Specialist finding	Authorised specialist finding
Dispute decision	Authorised business decision
Refund approval	Applicable authorised approval
Fraud determination	Applicable specialist/human authority

Source Evidence ≠ AI Summary ≠ Human Finding ≠ Specialist Finding ≠ Final Decision

The use of AI does not collapse these separate business states.

153. EP-10 Responsible AI Control Coverage

Control Area	Covered By
Grounded generation	US-061
Source-evidence separation	US-061
Missing/uncertain information handling	US-061
Human review	US-062

Correction	US-062
Rejection / disregard	US-062
Authority boundaries	US-061, US-062
AI output traceability	US-061, US-062
Safe AI failure	US-061
Non-AI continuation	US-061, US-062
Pilot quality evaluation	US-063
Error/omission evaluation	US-063
Human-review outcome evaluation	US-063
Operational-value evaluation	US-063
Stop/restrict option	US-063
Production approval not assumed	US-063

EP-10 contains generation, human oversight and evaluation controls. Wider AI adoption is therefore treated as an evidence-based future decision rather than an assumed project outcome.

154. EP-10 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-061	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-062	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-063	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The three Stories have logical dependencies because generation must exist before human review and evaluation can occur. However, each represents a distinct testable business capability and control objective.

156. BA Interpretation — Evidence Summarisation Pilot

EP-10 demonstrates a controlled approach to applying generative AI to a bounded business problem.

Rather than placing AI directly into decision authority, PayFix AI 2.0 uses AI as an assistive summarisation capability positioned between authoritative evidence and human review.

The backlog explicitly separates source evidence, AI-generated content, human findings and authorised business decisions.

The pilot also includes a formal evaluation capability so that future adoption can be based on observed quality, operational usefulness, limitations and control performance.

A decision to restrict, modify or stop the AI capability remains a valid evaluation outcome.

157. Evidence Summarisation Backlog Conclusion

EP-10 contains three H3 controlled AI pilot User Stories: US-061 through US-063.

Together they define:

1. grounded generation of a draft evidence summary;
2. explicit human review, correction, rejection or disregard; and
3. controlled pilot evaluation before any wider adoption decision.

All three Stories have been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready and are classified as **Ready for future pilot delivery refinement**.

This status does not mean that an AI model has been implemented, tested or approved for production.

The PayFix AI 2.0 portfolio now contains **63 User Stories — US-001 through US-063**.

158. EP-11 — AI Pilot: Handoff Summarisation

EP-11 defines the second and final initial H3 AI pilot selected for PayFix AI 2.0.

The pilot focuses on AI-assisted summarisation of relevant case and workflow context when work is transferred between authorised operational users, queues or specialist functions.

The capability is intended to reduce the effort required for a receiving user to reconstruct the case history and identify relevant completed work, outstanding activity and transfer context.

The capability follows an assistive model:

Authoritative Case Context → AI Draft Handoff Summary → Human Review → Receiving User Continues Controlled Processing

The AI-generated summary is a derived assistance artefact.

It does not create the actual ownership transfer, grant decision authority, establish specialist findings, change source evidence or create a final dispute outcome.

Existing H1/H2 routing, assignment, ownership, audit, exception, failure, fallback and recovery capabilities remain authoritative and continue to operate without AI.

158.1 EP-11 Requirements Basis

Requirement Type	Main Coverage
Business	Ownership, handoff quality, traceability, reduced reconstruction effort
Functional	Existing routing, assignment and handoff processes remain authoritative
Data	Case relationships, ownership, lifecycle, evidence and outstanding-state context
Control	Human review, authority separation, access, correction/rejection and traceability
NFR	Reliability, security, privacy, usability, auditability and integration
AI Requirements	Grounding, human oversight, authority boundaries, safe failure and evaluation
Process	Cross-lifecycle ownership/handoff

Horizon	H3 — Controlled AI Pilot
Core Dependency	H1/H2 handoff remains available without AI

Exact AIR, DR, CR and NFR Story-level IDs will be allocated only against the authoritative Step 24 Requirements Baseline.

Unvalidated individual requirement IDs will not be invented.

Handoff Boundary

PayFix AI 2.0 distinguishes:

Authoritative Case Context ≠ AI Handoff Summary ≠ Ownership Transfer ≠ Human Finding ≠ Final Decision

AI assists the receiving user's understanding of context.

It does not establish the authoritative business state merely by describing it.

State-Integrity Principle

The handoff summary should preserve material distinctions between completed, outstanding, waiting, referred, reviewed, decided, approved, communicated and closed states.

An AI-generated summary must not compress different lifecycle states in a way that changes their business meaning.

Authority Principle

Assignment or receipt of a handoff does not automatically grant all business authority.

AI-generated wording cannot create decision authority, approval authority, override authority or specialist authority that is not already established by the applicable control model.

Pilot Evaluation Principle

EP-11 will later be evaluated using representative synthetic PayFix AI 2.0 handoff scenarios.

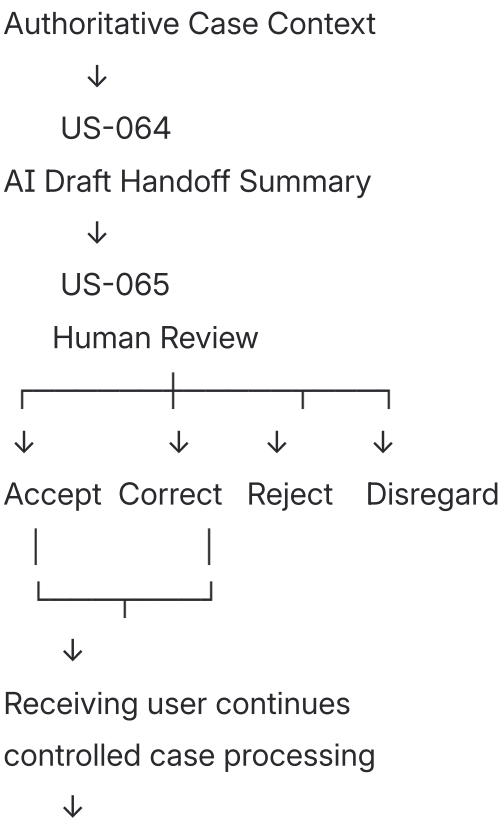
Evaluation will consider grounding, factual consistency, omission of important context, state accuracy, human-review behaviour, usability, operational usefulness and safe continuation without AI.

No production-readiness conclusion is predetermined.

159. EP-11 User Story Catalogue

Story ID	Story	Horizon	Priority	AI Role	Status
US-064	Generate a Grounded Draft Handoff Summary	H3	Should	Draft generation	Backlog
US-065	Review, Correct or Reject an AI-Generated Handoff Summary	H3	Should	Human-control layer	Backlog
US-066	Evaluate the Handoff Summarisation AI Pilot	H3	Should	Pilot evaluation	Backlog

160. EP-11 AI Control Chain



US-066

Controlled Pilot Evaluation



Evidence-based recommendation



Continue / Modify / Restrict /

Evaluate Further / Stop

The AI-generated handoff summary remains a derived assistance artefact. It does not perform the ownership transfer, establish authoritative case state, grant business authority or create the final dispute outcome.

161. EP-11 Handoff and Authority Boundaries

Concept	Authoritative Role
Case lifecycle state	Authoritative case/process record
Current owner / queue	Controlled ownership record
Ownership transfer	H1/H2 controlled process
Case evidence	Authoritative evidence record
AI handoff summary	Derived assistance artefact
Human-reviewed summary	Reviewed assistance artefact
Investigation finding	Human-controlled finding
Specialist finding	Authorised specialist finding
Decision	Authorised business decision
Approval	Applicable authorised approval

Case Context ≠ AI Summary ≠ Ownership Transfer ≠ Finding ≠ Decision

AI summarisation assists understanding of an existing business state. It does not create that state.

162. EP-11 Responsible AI Control Coverage

Control Area	Covered By
--------------	------------

Grounded generation	US-064
Authoritative-state separation	US-064
Completed/outstanding distinction	US-064
Ownership accuracy	US-064
Lifecycle-state integrity	US-064
Uncertainty/conflict handling	US-064
Human review	US-065
Correction	US-065
Rejection / disregard	US-065
Authority separation	US-064, US-065
AI output traceability	US-064, US-065
Safe AI failure	US-064
Non-AI handoff continuation	US-064, US-065
State-accuracy evaluation	US-066
Human-review evaluation	US-066
Operational-value evaluation	US-066
Stop/restrict option	US-066
Production approval not assumed	US-066

163. EP-11 INVEST Review

Story	Independent	Valuable	Small	Testable	Result
US-064	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-065	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable
US-066	Mostly	Yes	Yes	Yes	Suitable

The Stories have intentional logical dependencies between AI generation, human oversight and evaluation. Each nevertheless represents a separate testable capability and control objective.

164. EP-11 Explicit Exclusions

EP-11 does not provide:

- autonomous routing;
- autonomous ownership transfer;
- AI-created case ownership;
- AI-created business authority;
- autonomous fraud determination;
- autonomous refund approval;
- autonomous specialist findings;
- autonomous dispute decisions;
- AI-created case facts;
- AI self-validation;
- production model selection;
- live-customer experimentation;
- assumed production readiness.

These exclusions are deliberate responsible-AI controls rather than missing functionality.

165. BA Interpretation — Handoff Summarisation Pilot

EP-11 demonstrates controlled use of generative AI in an operational handoff context.

The capability addresses a genuine process-friction area identified through the PayFix AI 2.0 analysis while preserving the distinction between case state, ownership, AI-generated assistance and human business authority.

The backlog explicitly considers inaccurate state representation, missing context, unsupported claims, over-reliance and AI failure rather than treating summarisation quality as a purely technical concern.

Wider adoption will depend on pilot evidence rather than being assumed in advance.

166. EP-11 — Handoff Summarisation Backlog Conclusion

EP-11 contains three H3 controlled AI pilot User Stories: US-064 through US-066.

Together they define:

1. grounded generation of an AI-assisted handoff summary;
2. explicit human review, correction, rejection or disregard; and
3. controlled pilot evaluation before wider adoption.

All three Stories have been reviewed against the portfolio Definition of Ready and are classified as **Ready for future pilot delivery refinement**.

This does not mean that an AI model has been implemented, tested or approved for production.

EP-11 completes the second and final initial controlled AI pilot backlog.

167. Final Product Backlog Architecture

Epic	Epic Name	Stories	Count	Horizon
EP-01	Dispute Intake and Case Creation	US-001-005	5	H1
EP-02	Classification, Routing and Ownership	US-006-015	10	H1
EP-03	Investigation and Evidence Management	US-016-022	7	H1
EP-04	Specialist Referral and Review	US-023-029	7	H1
EP-05	Decision and Approval Controls	US-030-034	5	H1
EP-06	Customer Status, Communication and Assisted Support	US-035-039	5	H1
EP-07	Complaints, Escalations and Closure	US-040-043	4	H1

EP-08	Process Data, Audit and Reporting	US-044-049	6	H1
EP-09	Rules, Controls and Service Resilience	US-050-060	11	H1 + H2
EP-10	AI Pilot — Evidence Summarisation	US-061-063	3	H3
EP-11	AI Pilot — Handoff Summarisation	US-064-066	3	H3
Total		US-001-066	66	

The Product Backlog contains 11 Epics and 66 User Stories.

The architecture deliberately separates the core dispute service, deterministic automation and controlled AI pilots.

168. Delivery Horizon and Prioritisation Model

Horizon	Purpose	Stories	Delivery Interpretation
H1	Core Process Foundation	US-001-055	Core service and controls
H2	Selective Automation	US-056-060	Optional deterministic efficiency layer
H3	Controlled AI Pilot	US-061-066	Evidence-gated AI experiments
H4	Conditional AI Expansion	None committed in Step 25	Only if future evidence supports expansion

H1 provides the business capability and control foundation.

H2 automates only selected deterministic activities while retaining the H1 route.

H3 introduces two bounded AI pilots under explicit human oversight.

H4 remains conditional and has no committed User Stories in the Step 25 baseline.

This prevents speculative AI expansion from being treated as committed scope.

169. Core, Automation and AI Separation

H1 — CORE SERVICE

Business Process

Rules

Data

Controls

Human Authority

Failure / Fallback

Audit / Reporting

|

↓

H2 — SELECTIVE AUTOMATION

Approved deterministic execution

|

↓

H3 — CONTROLLED AI PILOTS

Evidence Summary

Handoff Summary

|

↓

Human Review + Pilot Evaluation

|

↓

Evidence-based future decision

|

↓

H4 only if justified

The PayFix AI 2.0 service is not architected as AI-dependent.

AI is an optional assisted capability positioned on top of an independently operable core service and deterministic control foundation.

170. Final Story Analysis Status

Status Dimension	Final Step 25 State
Stories defined	66
Epic architecture	11 Epics
User Story format	Complete
Acceptance Criteria	Defined
Traceability	Established at portfolio level
Definition of Ready	Reviewed
Delivery estimates	Not committed
Sprint allocation	Not committed
Implementation	Future
Testing/UAT	Future
AI pilot execution	Future
Production deployment	Not implied

Ready means sufficiently analysed for future delivery refinement.

It does not mean implemented, tested, accepted in UAT or released.

171. Step 25 Final Backlog Quality Review

Quality Check	Result
Core service can operate without AI	Pass
H1 can operate without H2 automation	Pass
Deterministic automation separated from AI	Pass
Human authority retained	Pass
Sensitive decisions not autonomously delegated	Pass

Source evidence remains authoritative	Pass
AI output remains derived assistance	Pass
Failure/fallback considered	Pass
Accessibility/human support retained	Pass
Synthetic evidence represented honestly	Pass
No fake live-user research	Pass
No fake AI performance results	Pass
No arbitrary AI success thresholds	Pass
No invented Jira estimates	Pass
No production readiness implied	Pass

172. Step 25 — Product Backlog, User Stories and Acceptance Criteria Conclusion

Step 25 has converted the approved PayFix AI 2.0 requirements and service design into a structured Agile Product Backlog consisting of 11 Epics and 66 User Stories.

The backlog covers the end-to-end H1 dispute process, cross-cutting data and control capabilities, H2 selective deterministic automation and two H3 controlled AI pilots.

User Stories include Given/When/Then acceptance criteria, requirement and process traceability, explicit scope boundaries, dependencies and Definition of Ready review.

Sensitive customer-impacting decisions, fraud determinations, approvals and material overrides retain applicable human authority.

AI capabilities are deliberately limited to evidence summarisation and handoff summarisation pilots. Both contain explicit grounding, human-review, safe-failure and evaluation controls.

No H4 AI expansion has been committed.

All 66 User Stories are classified as **Ready for future delivery refinement**, not implemented.

Product Backlog analysis for Step 25 is therefore complete.